

Frankenstein The Hesitations

Surviving text on paper. Deleted text on vellum.

Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus (MS. Abinger c. 56, Volume I)

The Shelley-Godwin Archive, github.com/umd-mith/sga (data/tei/ox/ox-ms_abinger_c56)

23348 surviving words · 4055 erased words

2028 deletions · 1879 micro · 149 macro

Erasure ratio 14.8%

.	A 11	The first fragment contains	—
.	Autograph	pp. 24-97 of the Standard	—
-	Part of the MS of	Novel edition.	-
-	Frankenstein	The second pp. 104-202, with	—
-	pp 64-172 (of vol I.?)	a slight interruption.	—
-	ch. 6-17	The third pp. 168-202, with	—
-	vol. II. pp 1-150	many imperfections.	—
-	ch I-XIV		
-	Corrections in another		
.	hand		
-	Dep. c. 477/1		

- Chapt. 2
— Those events which materially influence our fu
— ture destinies often derive thier origin from a tri
— vial occurence .
—
— Natu
— ral philosophy is the genius that has
— regulated my fate I desire the refore in this account
— of my early years to state those facts which
— led to my predeliction for that science. When
— I was eleven years old we all went on a party
— of pleasure to the baths near Thonon.
— The inclemen
— cy of the weather obliged us to remain a day
— confined to the inn. In this house I chanced
— to fin d a volume of the Works of Corne
— lius Agrippa. I opened it with apathy
— the theory that he attempted to ddemonstrate and the wonderful facts that he relates
— soon changed this feeling into enthusiasm. A new
— light dawned upon my mind and
— bounding with joy I communicated my
— discovery to my father. I cannot help here remark
— ing the many opportunities instructors possess
— of directing the attention of their pupils to
— useful knowledge, which they utterly neglect.
— My father looked carelessly at the tit le page
— of my book — and said Ah! Cornelius
— Agrippa! — My dear Victor do not waste
— your time upon this – it is sad trash.
— If instead of this remark or rather excla
— mation my father had taken the pains to
— exp lain to me that the principles of

Agrippa had been entirely exploded.
— and that a modern system of science
— had been introduced which possessed much
— greater power than the ancient because
— the powers of the ancient were pretended
— and chimerical, while those of the moderns
— are real and practical; under such
— circumstances I should certainly have thrown
— Agrippa aside, and with my imagination
— warmed as it was should probably have
— aplied myself to the more rational
— theory of chemistry which has resulted from modern discoveries
— It is even possible that the train of my ideas might never have
— recieved that fatal impulse which led me to my ruin. But the
— cursory glance my father had taken of
— my volume by no means assured me
— that he was acquainted with its contents;
— and I continued to read with the greatest
— avidity. When I returned home, my first
— care was to procure the whole works of this
— author and afterwards those of Paracel-
— sus and Albertus Magnus. I read and studied
— the wild fancies of these authors with
— delight, they appeared to me treasures
— known to few besides myself; and, although
— I often wished to communicate these secret stores
— of knowledge to my father yet his in

— definite censure of my favorite Agrippa,
— always withheld me. I disclosed my secret
— to Elizabeth therefore, under a strict promise
— of secrecy; but she did not interest herself
— in the subject, and I was left by her to pursue
— my studies alone. —
— It may appear very strange that a descen-
— dant of Albertus Magnus should arise in the
— eighteenth century, but our family was not
— scientific, and I had not attended any of the
— lectures given at Geneva. My dreams were
— therefore undisturbed by reality, and I entered
— with the greatest diligence into the search
— of the philosophers stone and the elixir of life
— or if you chose petrum philosophale
— . But the latter obtained my most undi-
— vided attention; wealth was an inferior
— object but what would be the glory
— of the discovery if I could
— banish disease from the human frame
— and render man invulnerable to any
—

— but a violent death. —
— Nor were these my only visions, the —
— raising of ghosts or devils was a promise liberally accorded by —
— my favourite authors; the fulfilment of which I most eagerly —
— sought;
— & if my incantations were always unsuccessful attributed the failure rather to my own —
— inexperience —
— and mistake, than to a want of skill or fidelity in —
— my instructors. —
— . —
— The natural phænonema that takes —
— place every day before our eyes did not —
— escape my examinations. —
— — stillation of which —
— my favorite authors were utterly ignorant —
— excited my astonishment, but my utmost —
— wonder was engaged by some experiments on an air —
— pump —
— which I saw employed by a gentleman whom —
— we were in the habit of visiting. —
— The ignorance of my philosophers on these —
— and several other points, served to decrease —

thier credit with me – but I could not entirely throw
them aside before some other system should
occup y d their place , in my mind–
Among other questions suggested by natural objects I eagerly enquired of my father
the nature & the origin of thunder and lightening. He
replied, electricity; describing at the same
time the effect of that power. He constructed
a small electrical machine and exhi
bited a few experiments and made a
kite with a wire & string which drew down
that fluid from the clouds.
This last stroke compleated
the overthrow of Cornelius Agrippa, Albertus
Magnus and Paracelsus, who had so long
reigned the lords of my imagination. But
by some fatality I did not feel enclined to
commence any modern system and this
disinclination was influenced by the following
circumstance.
My father expressed a wish that I
should attend a course of lectures upon
natural philosophy, to which I cheerfully consented

Some accident prevented my attending the these
lectures
until it was nearly finihsed.
The
lecture which I attended being thus almost the last in his course was entirely
incomprehensible to me. – the professor talked
with the greatest fluency of potassium &
Boron – of sulphats and oxids
terms to which
I could affix no idea: I was
disgusted with a science
that appeared to me to contain only words.
From this time untill I went to
Colledge I entirely neglected my formerly
adored study of the science of natural philosophy although I still
read with delight Pliny and Buffons
authors
in my estimation of nearly equal interest & utility.
My occupations at this age were principally the
mathematics, and most
of the branches of study appertaining to that
science. I was also busily employed in learning
languages Latin was already familiar to me and I began to
read without the help of the lexicon some of the
easiest greek authors. –I also understood English &
german perfectly: th is is list of my accom-
plishments at the age of and you may
conceive that my hours were fully employd
in acquiring and maintaining a knowledge
of this various literature.

servants had any request to make
it always through her intercession

For, although
was a great dissimilitude in our
characters. I was more calm and philosophical than my companion
Yet I was not so mild or yielding.
My application was of longer endurance
but it was not so severe
while it endured

My brothers were considerably younger than myself but I had
a friend in one of my school
fellows who compensated for this deficiency. Henry
Clerval was the son of a merchant
of Geneva an intimate friend
of my father – he was a boy of singular talent & fancy I remember
when he was only nine years old he
wrote a fairy tale which was the
delight and amazement of all his
companions. his
favourite study consisted in books of chivalry & romance and when very young, I can remember that we used to
act plays composed by him out of
these books, the principal
characters of which were Orlando
Robin Hood, Amadis and St. George–
No youth could be more happy

X
X
yet
there was an
harmony in
that very dissimilitude–
We were strangers
to any species
of disunion
or dispute
I delighted in
investigating
the facts relating
to the actual
world, she
busied herself
in following the aerial
creations of the
poets.– The
world was to me
a secret which
I desired to discover,–to her it
was a
vacancy which
she sought to
people with
imaginings of
her own.

than mine. – My parents were indulgent, and my companions amiable.

Our studies were never
forced, and by some means we always had an end placed in view which
excited us to ardour in the prosecution of them. It was by this method
not by emulation that we were
urged. Elizabeth was not told to apply
herself to drawing that her companions
might not outstrip her, but by the
pleasing her Aunt
by the representation of some
favourite scene done by her own
hand. We learned Latin &
English that we might read the writings in those
languages and so far from study
begin rendered odious to us through
punishment, we loved application
and our amusements would have been the
labours of other children. perhaps
we did not read so many books
or learn languages so quickly
as those who are disciplined according to the ordinary method, but what we
learned was impressed the more deeply on our
memory. Henry Clerval,
for he was constantly
with us. he went to school
with me and generally passed
the afternoon at our house for
desire of
In the description of our domestic circle
I include

being an only child, and destitute of companions at home, his father was pleased that he should find associates at our house and we were never completely happy when Clerval was absent.

When I was about fourteen years old we were at our house near Belrive when we witnessed a violent and terrible thunder storm

it advanced from behind Jura
and the thunder

burst at once with
frightful loudness, from various quarters of the heavens I

and remained while the storm lasted watching its
As I stood at the door

,on a sudden I beheld a stream of fire issue
 from an old and beautiful
 oak about twenty yards from
 our house and so soon as the
 dazzling light

vanished, the oak
 had dissappeared & nothing remained but a
 blasted stump. . When we

visited it the next morning we found the tree shattered in a singular manner. It was not splintered by the shock, but entirely reduced to thin ribands of wood.

I never saw any thing so utterly destroyed. The catastrophe of the tree excited my extreme astonishment

its progress
with curiosity
& delight

Another task also devolved upon me when I became the instructor of my brothers. Ernest was five years younger than myself, and was my principal pupil. He had been afflicted with ill health from his infancy thro which Elizabeth and I had been his constant nurses his disposition was gentle but he was incapable any severe application. William the youngest of our family was quite a child and the most beautiful little fellow in the world, his lively blue eyes dimpled cheeks

and endearing manners inspired the tenderest affection. Such was our domestic circle from which care and pain seemed for ever banished. My father directed our studies and my mother partook of our enjoyments. the voice of command was never heard among us but mutual affection engaged us all to comply with, & to obey the slightest desire of each other. neither of us possessed an envied preheminance over the other

- Chapter 3
— When I had attained the age of
— seventeen my parents resolved that
— I should at the university of In-
— golstadt. I had hitherto attended the
— schools of Geneva, but my father thought
— it necessary for the completion of my
— education that I should be
— acquainted with other customs than
— those of my native country. My depar-
— ture was therefore fixed at an
— early date. But before the day resolved
— upon could arrive the first mis-
— fortune of my life occurred: an
— omen as it were of my future misery
.
— >Elizabeth had caught the scar-
— let fever but her illness was
— not severe and she quickly recovered.
— During her confinement many ar-
— guments had been urged to persuade
— my mother to refrain from attending upon
— her. She had yielded to our entreaties, but
— when she heard that her
— favourite was recovering, she could
— no longer debar herself from her
— society, and entered her sick cham-
— ber long before the danger of infection was past. The
— become a student
— made
.

consequences of this imprudence were
fatal: on the third day my mother
sickened. Her fever was malign-
ant, and the looks of her atten-
dants prognosticated the worst
evil. On her death bed the forti-
tude and benignity of this admirable woman
did not desert her. She joined the
hands of Elizabeth and myself. “My
“children said she it was on your
“union that my firmest hopes of
“future happiness were placed. It
“will now be the consolation of
“your father. Elizabeth, my
“love, supply my place to
“your young cousins. Alas! I
“regret than I am taken from you,
“and happy and beloved, as I am
“is it not hard to quit you all? But
“these are not thoughts befitting me
“I will endeavour to resign myself cheerfully to
“death and will indulge a hope
“of meeting you
“in another world.”
She died calmly and her features
expressed affection even in death.
I need not describe the feelings of those

— whose dearest ties are rent by that
— most irreparable evil; the void
— that every where presents itself to
— the soul and the despair that
— is exhibited on the countenance.
— It is so long before the mind can
— persuade itself that she, whom
— they saw every day, and whose very
— existence appeared a part of theirs,
— can have departed for ever: that
— the brightness of a loved eye can have
— been extinguished, and the sound of a voice
— so familiar and dear to the ear
— can be hushed, never more to be
— heard. These are the reflections of the
— first days. But when the lapse of
— time proves the reality of the evil
— then the bitterness of grief commences,
—
— Yet, from whom who has not
— that rude hand
— and why should I describe a sorrow
— which all have felt, and must
— feel? The time at length arrives
— when grief is rather an indulgence
— than a necessity and the smile
— that plays on the lips, although
— it is deemed sacrilege, is not
— banished.— My mother lost
— was dead but we had still
— rent away some
— dear connection,

— duties which we ought to perform
— we must continue our course with
— the rest
—
— My journey to Ingolstadt which had
— been deferred by these events was now
— again determined upon,
— I obtained from my father a
— respite of some weeks. This time
— was spent sadly. My mothers death
— and my speedy departure depressed
— our spirits but Elizabeth endeavour
— ed to renew the spirit of cheer
— fullness in our little society. Since
— the death of her aunt her mind
— acquired new firmness and
— vigour. She determined to fulfil her
— duties with the greatest exactitude
— and she felt that the most imperious duty of
— rendering her uncle and cousins hap
— py. She consoled me, amused her uncle,
— instructed my brothers and I never
— beheld her so enchanting as at this
— time when she
— was continual
— ly endeavouring to contribute to the
— happiness of others entirely forgetful
— and learn
— to think our
— -selves fortun
— ate,
— whilst
— one remains
— whom the
— spoiler has
— not seized. had
— had devolved
— on her.

- of herself.
— The day of my departure at length
— arrived – I had taken leave of all
— my friends excepting Clerval, who spent
— the last evening with us. He bitterly la-
— mented that he was unable to
— accompany me But his father
— could not be persuaded to part with him
— intend ing that he should be-
— come a partner with him in
— his business, and

Henry had a refined mind
he had no desire to be idle
and was well pleased to become
his father's partner but he believed
that a man might be a very good
trader and yet possess a cultivated
understanding.

We sate late listening to his com-
plaints, and making many little
arrangements for the future. The
next morning early I departed. Tears
gushed from the eyes of Elizabeth
they proceeded partly from sorrow
at my departure, and partly because
she reflected that the same journey
was to have taken place three
months before when a mothers
blessing would have accompanied me

in
compliance
with his favou-
rite theory,
that learning
was superflous
in the com-
-merce of ordi-
nary life.

— I threw myself into the chaise
— that was to convey me away and in
— dulged in the most melancholy reflec-
— tions. I who had ever been surrounded
— by amiable companions, continually
— engaged in endeavouring to give
— mutual pleasure; I was now alone.
— In the university whither I was
— going I must form my own friends
— and be my own protector. My
— life had hitherto been remarkably retired
— and domestic and this had given me
— an invincible repugnance to new
— countenances. I loved my brothers Eliza-
— beth and Clerval these were “old
— familiar faces” but I believed my
— self totally unfitted for the compa-
— ny of strangers. Such were my reflec-
— tions as I commenced my journey But
— as I proceeded my spirits and hopes
— rose. I ardently desired knowledge
— often when at home
— thought it hard to remain
— cooped up in one place
— and had longed to enter into the
— world and take my
— among other human beings.
— now my desires were complied
— with & it would indeed have been folly to
— repent.
— I had sufficient leisure for these
— I had
— during my youth
— station

— and many other reflections during
— my journey to Ingolstadt which was
— long and fatiguing – at length the
— steeples of the town met my eyes. I
— alighted and was conducted to my
— solitary apartment to spend the
— evening as I pleased.

Chap. 4
The next morning I delivered my
letters of introduction and paid a
visit to some of the principal
professors. and among others to M.
Professor of Natural
philosophy. He received me with
politeness, and asked me several
questions concerning my progress
in the different branches
of science appertaining to natural
philosophy. I mentioned, it is true
with fear and trembling, the only
authors I had ever read upon those
subjects. The professor stared.

“Have you really” said he “spent
“your time in studying such
“nonsense?” I replied in the affir
mative.
“Every minute”– continued M.
with warmth,” every instant that
“you have wasted upon those
“books is utterly and entirely lost.
“You have burdened your
“ memory with exploded
“systems and useless names. Good
“God in what desart land have you
“lived where no one was kind
“enough to inform you
“that these fancies which you have
Krempe
Krempe

— “so greedily imbibed are a —
— “thousand years old and as musty as —
— “ they are ancient. I little expected —
— “in this enlightened and scientific age —
— “to find a disciple of Albertus Mag —
— “nus and Paracelsus. My dear sir —
— “you must begin your studies entire —
— “ly anew.” So saying he stepped aside, and —
— wrote down a list of several —
— books upon natural philosophy —
— which he desired me to procure —
— and dismissed me after mentioning —
— that in —
— the beginning of the next week —
— he intended to commence a course —
— of lectures upon natural philosophy —
— and that M. Waldham a fellow professor —
— would lecture upon chemistry —
— the alternate days which he missed. —
— I returned home not dissatisfied —
— for I had long considered the au- —
— thors useless which the professor —
— had so strongly reprobated – but I —
— did not feel very much inclined —
— to study those books which at —
— his recommendation I had —
— procured. M. Kempe was a little squat —
— man with a gruff voice and repul- —
— sive countenance and the teacher —
— did not prepossess me in favour —
— in its general relations;

of his doctrine. Be- —
sides I had a contempt for the uses —
of modern natural philosophy . It was very —
different when the masters —
of the science sought immortality —
and power ;– such views although —
futile were grand; but now the scene was —
changed. —

Such were my reflections during —
two or three days spent almost in —
but as the ensuing week —
commenced I thought of the infor- —
mation Mr. Kempe had given me —
concerning the lectures, and although —
I could not consent to go and hear —
that little conceited fellow deliver —
sentences out of a pulpit I recollected what he had —
said of Mr. Waldham, whom I had —
never seen as he had been —
hitherto out of town. —

Partly from curiosity and partly from —
idleness I went into the lecturing room —
which Mr. Waldham entered shortly —
after. This Professor was a very dif- —
ferent man from his colleague . He —
was about fifty but with aspect ex- —
pressive of the greatest benevolence —
a few grey hairs covered his temples —
the —
ambition of —
enquirer seemed —
to limit itself —
to the annihi- —
lation of those —
visions on which —
solitude: —
my interest in science —
was chiefly founded. —
I was required —
to exchange —
chimeras of —
boundless grandeur, —
for realities of —
little worth. —

— but those at the back of his head —
— were nearly black. He was short in —
— person but remarkably erect and —
— his voice the sweetest I had ever —
— heard. He began his lecture with a —
— history of chemistry and —
— the various improvements —
— men of learning pronouncing —
— the names of the greatest discoverers —
— . He then took —
— a cursory view of the present state —
— of the science, and explained many —
— of its terms. After making a few —
— preparatory experiments he conclu —
— ded with a panegyric upon modern chemist —
— ry the words of which I shall never —
— forget. —
— “The ancient teachers of this science” —
— said he, “promised impossibilities —
— “and performed nothing. The modern —
— “masters promise very little. They —
— “ know that metals cannot be —
— “transmuted and that the elixir —
— “ is a chimæra. But —
— “these philosophers whose hands —
— “appear only made to dabble in —
— “dirt and their eyes to pore over —
— “the microscope or cruscible, —
— “have indeed performed miracles. —
— “They penetrate into the recesses of —
— “nature and show how she works —
— by a recapitu —
— lation of the made by various with fervour of life

— “in her hiding places. They ascend into —
— “the heavens;— they have discoverd how —
— “the blood circulates, and the nature —
— “of the air we breathe. They have —
— “acquired new and almost unlimi —
— ted powers ; — They can command the —
— “thunders of heaven, mimic the —
— “earthquake, and even mock the —
— “invisible world with its own —
— “shadows.” —
— I departed highly pleased with —
— the professor and his lecture & —
— paid him a visit the same evening. —
— His manners in private were even —
— more mild & attractive than in public. For —
— there was a certain dignity in his —
— manner during his lectures which —
— was replaced by the greatest —
— affability and kindness in his own —
— house. He heard my little narration —
— concerning my studies with attention —
— smiled at the names of Cornelius —
— Agrippa and Paracelsus but without —
— the contempt that Mr Krempe had —
— expressed to them . that —
— his lecture had removed my prejudice —
— against modern chemists and I request- —
— ed at the same time his advice —
— concerning the books I ought to procure —
— He said that —
— these were —
— men to whose —
— indefatigable zeal —
— modern natural —
— philosophers were —
— indebted for most —
— of the foundations —
— of their knowledge —
— . —
— They had left to —
— us, as an easier —
— task to give new —
— names, & arrange —
— in conected classi —
— fications the —
— facts which they —
— to a great degree —
— ha d been the —
— instruments of —
— bringing to light. —
— The labours of —
— men of genius —
— however erroneously —
— directed scarce —
— ly ever failed. —

“I am happy” said Mr. Waldham, “To
“have gained a desciple and if if your
“ application equals your ability
“I have no doubt of your success. Che
“mistry is that branch of natural
“philosophy in which the greatest im-
“provements have been & may be made.
“It is on that account that I sl
“chose it for my peculiar study. But
“at the same time I did not neglect the
“other sciences. A man would make
“a very sorry chemist if he atteneded
to that department alone. If
“your wish is really to become a
“man of science and not merely
“a pretty experimentalist I should
“advi se you to apply to every
“branch of natural philosophy
“Mathematics.”

He then took me into his
laboratory and explain
ed to me the use of his various machines
what I ought to procure
and promising me
the use of his own when I should
have advanced far enough in
the study not to des derange
in ultimately
turning to the
solid advantage of
mankind. I listen
ed to his state
ment which
was delivered
without any
presumption
& then added
including
instructing me as to

the ir . mechanism. He also gave me the list of
books which I had requested and
I took my leave.
Thus ended a day memorable
to me for it decided my
destiny.

- Chap. 5
— From this day natural philosophy and parti-
— cularly chemistry became nearly my sole
— study. I read with ardour those books
— so full of genius and discrimination
— on these sub-
— jects. I attended the lectures, and culti-
— vated the acquaintance of the men
— of science of the university; and I found
— even in Mr Krempe a great deal
— of sound sense & real information
— combined it is true with a repulsive
— phisiognomy & manners, but not on
— that account the less valuable.
— In M. Waldman I found a true friend.
— His gentleness was never tinged by
— dogmatism and his instructions were
— given with an air of frankness and
— good nature that banished every idea
— of pedantry. It was perhaps the
— amiable character of this man that
— enclined me more to the study of that
— branch of natural philosophy which he professed than an intrinsic
— love for the science itself. But this
— only in the first steps towards the
— knowledge; the more fully I entered into
— science the more I pursued it
— for its own sake. That application
— which at first had been a matter
— of duty & resolution, now became so ardent
— and eager that the stars often
— dissapeared while I was yet engaged
— in my labrotary.
— which modern
— enquirers
—
—
— state of mind had
— place
— in the light of
— morning

As I applied so closely, it may be
easily conceived that I improved rapid-
ly. My ardour was indeed the astonish-
ment of the students, and my proficiency
that of the master. Professor Krempe
often asked me with a sly smile
how Cornelius Agrippa went on ; Two
years passed in this manner during
which I paid no visit to Geneva, but
was engaged heart and soul in the
pursuit of some discoveries which I
hoped to make. None but those
who have experienced it can conceive
of the enticements of science— In
other studies you go as far as others have
going one before you and there is nothing
more to know, learn, but in a scientific
pursuit there is continual
food for discovery and wonder. A mind
of moderate capacity who closely pursues
one study must infallibly arrive at
great proficiency in that study—And I
who continually sought the attainment of one
object and was wrapt up in this sole
improved so rapidly that at the end
of the two years I made some
discoveries in the improvement
of some chemical instruments which pro-
cured me great esteem and admiration
at the university. When I arrived at
this point, my residence
while M. Waldham
expressed the most
heartfelt exultation
in my progress.
pursuit
and had learned
all the professors
at Ingolstadt were
qualified to teach

— no longer conducive to —
— my improvement, I thought of returning —
— to my friends and to my native town, —
— when an incident happened that —
— protracted my stay. —
— One of those phænonoma which —
— had peculiarly attracted my atten —
— tion was the structure of the human —
— frame; and indeed that of any animal —
— endued with life. Whence I often asked —
— myself did this principle of life proceed. —
— It was a bold question, and one —
— has ever been considered as a mystery. —
— Yet how many things are we on the —
— brink of becoming acquainted with —
— if cowardice or carelessness did —
— not restrain our enquiries? . I revolved these circum —
— stances in my mind and determined —
— from thenceforth to apply myself more —
— particularly to those branches of natural —
— philosophy which relate to phisiology. —
— Unless I had been animated by an al- —
— most supernatural enthusiasm, my —
— application to this study would have —
— been irksome and almost intolerable. —
— To examine the causes of life we must —
— first have recourse to death. —
— I became acquainted —
— with the science of anatomy but this —
— was not sufficient. I must also observe —
— the natural decay & corruption of the —
— human body. In my education —
— there being —
— which

— my father had taken the greatest —
— precautions that my mind should —
— be impressed by ^ no supernatural —
— horrors. I do not ever remember —
— having trembled at tale of superstition or —
— to have feared the apparition of a spirit —
— Darkness had no effect upon my —
— fancy and a churchyard was to —
— me merely ^ as the receptacle of —
— bodies deprived of life and which —
— from being the seat of beauty & —
— strength ^ become food for the worm. —
— c now I was —
— led to examine the cause & progress —
— of this decay and forced to spend days —
— and nights in vaults and Charnel —
— houses. I My attention was —
— fixed upon every object the most insupportable to the delicacy of —
— the human feelings. —
— I saw how the fine form of man —
— degraded and wasted. I beheld the —
— corruption of death succeed to the bloom —
— -ing cheek of life – I saw how the worm —
— inherited the wonders of the eye and —
— brain. I paused, examin ing and anal yzing —
— untill —
— from the midst of this darkness —
— a sudden light broke in upon me. —
— A light so brilliant & wondrous yet —
— was —
— all the minutiae —
— of causation —
— as exemplified in —
— the change from —
— life to death, & —
— death to life, —
—

— so simple that while
— I was surprised that I
— among so many men of genius
— who had applied to the same science
— that I alone should discover
— this astonishing secret.
— Remember I am not recording the
— vision of a madman – the
— sun does not more certainly shine
— in the heavens than that which
— I now affirm, is true. Some miracle
— might have produced it. But the
— stages of discovery were distinct
— and probable. After days and nights
— of incredible labour and fatigue
— I succeeded in discovering the
— cause of generation & life. Nay
— more, I became myself capable of
— bestowing animation upon lifeless
— matter.
— The surprise which I at first experienced
— on this discovery soon gave place to
— delight and rapture.
— to arrive at once
— at the summit of my desires
— was the most gratifying circumstance
— that could have occurred. But this
— discovery was so great and overwhelm
— ing that all the
— I became dizzy
— with the immen
— sity of the prospect
— which it illus
— trated,
— After so much
— time spent in
— painful labour

steps by which I had been progressively led to it were
obliterated. and I beheld only the result. What
had been the study and desire of the
wisest men since the creation of
the world was now within my grasp; Not
that, like a magic scene it
all opened upon me at once.
The information
I had obtained was of a nature rather
to direct my endeavours.

I was like the
Arabian who had been buried with
the dead, and found a passage to life
aided only by one glimmering and seem
ingly ineffectual light.
I see by your eagerness and the
wonder and hope which your eyes
express, my friend, that you expect to
be informed of the secret with
which I am acquainted ; that cannot be.
Listen patiently to the end
of my story and you will easily
perceive why I am reserved upon that
subject.— I will not lead you
on, unguarded and ardent as I then
was, to your destruction &
so soon as I
should point
them towards
the object of
my search,
than to exhibit that ob
ject already
accomplished.

— infallible misery. Learn from me, if
— not by my precepts at least by my exam
— ple, how dangerous is the acquirement
— of knowledge and how much happier
— that man is who believes his native
— town the world, than he
— aspires to become greater than his
— nature will allow.

Chapter 6.
When I found so astonishing a power
placed within my hands, I hesitated a long time
concerning the manner in which I should employ it.
Although I possessed
the capacity of bestowing animation yet
to prepare a frame for the reception of it with all its intri
cacies of fibres muscles & veins
a work of inconceivable labour & diffi
culty. I doubted at first whether I should
attempt the creation of a being
like myself or one of simpler
organization; but my imagination
was too much exalted by my first success
to permit me to doubt of my
ability to give life to an animal as complex
and wonderful as man.

my command hardly appeared adequate to so arduous
an undertaking; but I doubted not that I should ultimately succeed.

the improvement which every day
takes place in science and mechanics
I was encouraged to hope

my present attempts would
at least lay the foundations of future success
still remained
The materials
at present within
I prepared myself
for a multitude
of reverses, my
operations
be baffled
incessantly, & at
last my work be
but imperfect,
yet, when I con
sidered

— I did not think that —
— the magnitude and complexity of my plan —
— as any argument of its impracticabi —
— lity. I t was with these feelings that I —
— began the creation of a human being. —
— As the minuteness of the parts formed a —
— great hindrance to my speed I resolved, —
— contrary to my first intention, to make —
— of a gigantic stature; that —
— is to say about seven or eight feet in —
— height, and proportionably large. —
— after having formed this determination —
— and having spent some months in —
— my materials, I began. —
— No one can conceive the variety —
— of feelings which pressed upon me —
— during this time. When success raised —
— me to enthusiasm life and death appear —
— ed to me ideal bounds, which I —
— should first break thro, and pour a —
— torrent of light into our dark world. —
— A new existence would bless me as its —
— and source; many happy and —
— excellent natures would owe their —
— being to me. —
— no father could claim —
— the gratitude of his child pur —
— sueing these reflections I thought —
— that if I could bestow animation upon —
— lifeless matter I might in —
— process of time (although I now found —
— Nor, could I —
— consider —
— the being —
— successfully —
— collecting & —
— arranging —
— creator —
— so completely as —
— I should deserve —
— thiers —

— it impossible) renew life where —
— death had apparently devoted the —
— body to corruption. —
— These thoughts supported my —
— spirits while I pursued my undertaking —
— with unremitting ardour . My cheek —
— pale with study, and my person —
— emaciated by confinement. sometimes —
— on the very brink of certainty I faild —
— yet I still clung to the hope which —
— the next day or the next —
— hour might realize. One secret —
— which I alone possessed was the hope —
— to which I clung and the moon —
— gazed on my midnight labours —
— while with unrelaxed & breathless —
— eagerness I pursued nature to her —
— most secret hiding places —
— who shall concieve the horrors of my secret toil —
— as I dabbled among the unhallowed —
— damps of the grave, or tortured the —
— living animal to —
— animate the lifeless clay? my limbs —
— tremble and my eyes swim with the —
— remembrance, but then a resistless —
— and almost frantic impulse urged me —
— ; I seemed to have lost all —
— soul or sensation but for one —
— pursuit. It was indeed a passing trance —
— that only made me feel with renew —
— had grown —
— became —
— now —
— forward —

— ed acuteness so soon as the unnatural sti
— mulus ceas ing to operate, and I had return
— ed to my old habits. I collected bones from
— Charnel houses and with profane fingers
— meddled with the secrets of the human
— frame. In a solitary chamber—or rather
— cell at the top of the house and seperated
— from all other appartments by a gallery
— and staircase I kept my workshop
— of filthy creation; my eyeballs were
— starting from their sockets in at-
— tending to the minutiae of my
— employment. The dissecting room and
— the slaughter house furnished many
— of my materials, and often did my
— human nature turn from my
— occupation whilst still urged
— on by an eagerness which perpetually encreased,
— my work near to a conclusion.
— The Summer months
— passed while I was thus engaged,
— heart and soul, in one pursuit. It
— was a most beautiful season: never
— did the fields bestow a more plentiful
— harvest, or the vines yeild a more
— luxuriant vintage. But my eyes were
— to the charms of nature & the
— same feelings which made me
— neglect the scenes around me caused
— me also to forget those friends who
— were so many miles absent and whom
— I had not seen for so long a time.
- I brought
- insensible

— I knew that my silence disquieted
— them and I well remembered the
— words of my father. “I know that while
— “you are pleased with yourself you
— “will think of us with affection
— “and we shall hear regularly from
— “you. And you must pardon me
— “if I regard any interruption
— “in your corespondence, as a proof
— “that your other duties are equal-
— “ly neglected” I knew well
— therefore what his would
— be his feelings but I could not tear my thoughts
— from my occupation loathsome in
— itself but which had taken an
— hold of my imagination.
— I wished as it were to procras
— tinate all that related to my feelings of affection, untill
— the great object which swallowed up every habit
— compleated.
— I then thought that my father
— would be unjust if he ascribed my
— neglect to vice or faultiness on my
— part; but I am now convinced
— that he was . A human
— being in perfection ought always to
— preserve a calm and peaceful
— mind and never to allow passion
— irresistible
— of my nature should be
— he was in the
— right in conceiv
— ing that I
— should not be
— altogether free
— from blame.
-

— or ^ a transitory desire to disturb his —
— tranquillity. I do not think that the pursuit —
— of knowledge is any exception to this rule. —
— If the study to which you apply yourself —
— has a tendency to weaken your affections —
— and to destroy your taste for those simple —
— pleasures in which no alloy can possibly —
— mix then that study is certainly unlawful —
— that is to say not befitting the —
— human mind. If this rule were al —
— ways observed; if no man allowed any —
— pursuit whatsoever to interfere with —
— his tranquillity and his domestic affections —
— Greece had never been enslaved, Cæsar —
— would have spared his country, America —
— would have been discovered more gradual —
— ly, and the Empires of Mexico & Peru had —
— not been destroyed. —
— But I forget that I am moralizing —
— in the most interesting part of my —
— tale; and your looks remind me to —
— proceed. —
— My father made no reproach in his —
— letters, and only took notice of my —
— silence by enquiring more particularly —
— than before what my occupations —
— were. Winter spring and summer —
— passed away during my labours but —
— I did not watch the blossom or the —
— expanding leaves – sights which before —
— had alway yeilded me supreme delight. —
— so deeply was I engrossed in my

— occupation. The leaves of that year —
— were withered before my work drew —
— near a close. And now every day shewed —
— me more plainly how well I had suc —
— ceeded. But my enthusiasm was —
— checked by my anxiety and I appeared —
— rather like one doomed by slavery —
— to toil in the mines or any other —
— unwholsome trade than an artist —
— occupied in his favourite employment. —
— Every night a slow fever oppressed —
— me and I became nervous to a —
— most painful degree; a a dis- —
— ease I regretted the more because I had —
— hitherto enjoyed excellent health & —
— had always —
— boasted of the firmness of my nerves. But I —
— believed that exercise and amusement —
— would soon drive away such sym- —
— -toms and I promised myself both —
— of these when my creation should be —
— comple te . —

Chapter 7th

It was on a dreary night of November
that I beheld my man comple ted ,
with an anxiety that almost amount
ed to agony I collected instruments of life
around me that I might i nfuse a
spark of being into the lifeless thin g
that lay at my feet. It was already
one in the morning, the rain pattered
dismally against the window panes, &
my candle was nearly burnt out, when
by the glimmer of the half extinguish-
ed light I saw the dull yellow eye of
the creature open.—It breathed hard,
and a convulsive motion agitated
its limbs.

How can I describe my
emotion at this catastrophe; or how deli
neate the wretch whom with such
infinite pains and care I had endeavoured
to form. His limbs were in proportion
and I had selected his features as
Beautiful ; Great God! His
skin scarcely covered the work of
muscles and arteries beneath; his hair
was flowing and his teeth of a pearly white
ness but these luxuriancies only
formed a more horrid contrast with
his watry eyes that seemed almost of
the same colour as the dun white
sockets in which they were set,
beautiful.
yellow
of a lustrous black &

his shrivelled complexion and strait black lips.

The different accidents of life are not so changeable as the feelings of human nature. I had worked hard for nearly two years for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body. For this I had deprived myself of rest and health. I had desired it with an ardour that far exceeded moderation; but now that I had succeeded these dreams vanished and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart. Unable to endure the aspect of the being I had created, I rushed out of the room and continued a long time traversing my bed chamber unable to compose my mind to sleep. At length I assuaged my tumult to the repose I had before endured, and I threw myself on my bed in my clothes endeavouring to seek a few moments of forgetfulness. But it was in vain; I slept indeed but I was disturbed by the wildest dreams—I saw Elizabeth in the bloom of health walking in the Ingolstadt; delighted & surprised I embraced her but as I imprinted the first kiss on her lips they became livid with the hue of death; her features appeared

— to change and I thought that I held —
— the corpse of my dead mother in my arms : —
— A shroud envolepped her form & I saw —
— the grave worms crawling in the folds of —
— the flannel; I started from my sleep with horror, a —
— cold dew covered my forehead —
— my teeth chattered and every limb —
— became convul s ed, when, by the dim and —
— yellow light of the moon as it forced —
— its way through the window shutters, I —
— beheld the wretch — the miserable —
— monster whom I had created; he hel d —
— up the curtain, and his eyes—; if eyes —
— they may be called,— were fixed on me—His —
— jaws opened and he muttered some —
— while a grin wrinkled his cheeks. He —
— might have spoken but I did not —
— hear — one hand was stretched out —
— to detain me but I escaped and —
— rushed down stair s I took refuge in —
— a court-yard belonging to the house —
— which I inhabited; where I remained —
— the rest of the night walking up and —
— down in the greatest agitation; listen —
— ing attentively, catching and fearing each —
— sound as if it were to announce the —
— arrival of the demoniacal corpse to —
— which I had so miserabl y given life. —
— Oh! no mortal could support —
— the horror of that countenance. A —
— mummy again endued with animation could not be —
— inarticulate —
— sounds —
— during

so hideous as He. I had gazed on him —
while unfinished; he —
was ugly then. But when those muscles —
and joints were endued with motion —
it became a thing such as even Dante —
could never have conceived. —
I passed the night wretchedly— —
sometimes my pulses beat so quickly a nd —
ha r dly that I felt the palpitation of —
every artery: At others I nearly sunk —
to the ground thro languor and ex- —
treme weakness. —

. —
Dreams that had been my food and —
rest for so long a space were now —
become a hell to me— and the —
change was so rapid, the overthrow —
so complete. —
Morning — dismal and wet — at leng th —
dawned, and discovered to my sleepless —
and aching eyes the church of Ingols- —
stadt its white steeple & its clock which —
pointed to the sixth hour. The porter —
opened the gates of the court which had —
that night been my assylum and I —
issued into the streets, pacing them with —
quick steps as if I sought to —
the wretch whom I feared every turn- —
ing in the street would present to —
and mingled —
with this hor —
ror I felt the —
bitterness of —
disappointment: —
avoid

— my view. I did not dare return
— to the appartment which I inhabited but
— felt impelled to hurry on although
— wetted by the rain which poured
— from a black and comfortless sky.
— I continued walking in this manner
— for some time endeavouring by bodily
— exercise to ease the load that weighed
— upon my mind. I traversed the streets
— without any clear conception of where
— I was or what I was doing: my heart
— palpitated in the sickness of fear and I hurried
— on with irregular steps not daring
— to look about me,
— “Like one who on a lon es ome road
— “doth walk in fear and dread
— “and having once turned round
— walks on
— “ And turns no more his head
— “Because he knows a frightful
— fiend
— “doth close behind him tread.”
— Continueing thus, I came at lenght
— opposite to the Inn at which the dili
— -gences and carriages usually stopped. Here
— I paused I knew not why but remained
— some minutes with my eyes fixed on
— a coach that was coming towards me
— from the other end of the street.
— As it drew nearer I observed that it
— was the Swiss diligence; it stopped
— just where I was standing, and on
— Coleridge’s
— “Ancient Mariner.”

— the doors being opened I perceived Henry
— Clerval, who on seeing me instantly
— sprung out.
— “My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed he
— “How glad I am to see you; how
— “fortunate that you should be here at
— the very moment of my alighting.”
— Nothing could equal my delight
— on seing Clerval: his presence
— brought back to my thoughts my fa-
— ther, Elizabeth and all those scenes
— of home so dear to my recollection.
— I grasped his hand, and in a moment
— forgot my horror and misfortune.
— I felt suddenly, and for the first time during for
— many months, calm and serene
— joy. I welcomed my friend therefore
— in the most cordial manner &
— we walked towards my colledge.
— Clerval continued
— talking for some time about our mutual
— friends and his owngood fortune in
— being allowed to come to Ingolstadt.
— “You may believe,” said he,
— “it was not with considerable
— “trouble that I persuaded my
— “father that it is not absolutely
— “necessary for a merchant to
— “know nothing except bookeeping

— “and indeed I believe I left him
— “incredulous to the last for his con
— “stant answer to my applications
— “was the same as that of the dutch school
— “master in the Vicar of Wakefield—
.
— “ I have ten thousand florins—
— “But his affection for me at
— “length overcame his dislike for
— “learning, and he permitted me
— “to under take a voyage of discoveryto the land of
— “knowledge.”
— “And my father, brothers & Eliza
— beth” said I
— “Very well & very happy” replied
— he “only a little uneasy that
— “they hear from you so seldom, &
— “by the bye, I mean to lecture you
— “a little upon their account
— “myself– But my dear Frankenstein”
— continued he stopping short & gazing
— “full in my face “I did not before
— “remark how very ill you are. So thin
— “and pale; you appear as if you had
— “been watching for several nights.”
— “You have guessed right” I replied
— “I have lately been so engaged in
— “ one occupation that I
— “not allow ed myself sufficient rest as you
— “ with
— “out greek –I
— “eat heartily
— “without greek
— of-
— have

— “see; but I hope, I sincerely hope all those
— “occupations are at an end—I am free
— “now I hope.”
— I trembled excessively: I could not
— bear to think of, & far less to allude
— to the occurences of the prece ding
— night. I
— walked therefore with a quick pace,
— and we soon arrived at my colledge.
— I then reflected – and the thought made
— me shiver that the creature whom
— I had left in my appartment might
— be still there—alive and walking
— about. I dreaded to see him but I
— dreaded still more that Henry should
— behold the monst er.
— entreat ing him therefore to remain a few
— minutes at the bottom of the
— stairs, I darted up towards
— my own room. My hand was already
— on the lock before I recovered
— myself, when I paused and a cold
— shivering came over me. I threw
— the door open as children are accus
— tomed to do when they expect
— a spectre to stand in waiting for
— them on the other side. But
— nothing appeared. I stepped fearfully
— in – the appartment was empty, and
— my bedroon was also freed from its
— hideous guest. I could hardly

— believe that so great a good fortune
— could have befallen me; but when
— I became assured that my enemy had
— indeed fled, I clapped my hands for
— joy and ran down to Henry.
— We ascended into my room & present
— ly the servant brought breakfast:
— but I was unable to contain my-
— self. It was not joy only that possess-
— ed me,—I felt my flesh tingle with
— the excess of sensitiveness and my
— pulse beat rapidly. I was unable to
— remain for a single instant in
— the same place — I jumped over
— the chairs, clapped my hands & laughed
— aloud. Clerval at first attributed
— my unusual spirits to joy on his
— arrival— but when he observed
— me more attentivelyhe saw a wildness in my eyes for
— which he could not account and
— my loud unrestrained heartless laugh
— -ter frightened and astonished him.
— My dear Frankenstein,” cried he “What
— for God’s sake is the matter do not
— laugh so – How ill you are!
— What is the cause of all this?
— Do not ask me cried I, putting my
— hands before my eyes, for I thought
— I saw the spectre glide into the

room – He can tell! Oh save me
save me”– I imagined that the
monster seized me I struggled furious
ly & fell down in a fit.
Poor Clerval! What must have been
his feelings. A meeting which
he had anticipated with such joy so
strangely turned to bitterness. But I
did not witness his grief for I was
lifeless and did not recover my
senses for a long, long time.

- Chap. 7
— This was the commencement of a nervous
— fever which confined me for several
— months. during all this time Henry was
— my only nurse. I afterwards learned that
— knowing my fathers advanced age
— and unfitness for so long a journey &
— wretched Elizabeth would be he
— had spared them this grief by conceal
— ing the extent of my disorder. He knew
— that I could not have a more kind
— & attentive nurse than himself, and
— firm in the hope he had of my recovery
— he did not doubt that instead of doing
— harm he performed the kindest action
— that he could towards them.
— But I was in reality very ill &
— surely nothing but the unbounded
— & unremitting attentions of
— my friend could have restored me to
— life. The form of the monster on whom
— I had bestowed life was for ever before
— myeyes, and I raved incessantly
— concerning him. DoubtlessMy words
— surprised Henry – he at first believed
— them the wanderings of my disordered
— imagination but the
— per tinacity with which I conti
— nually recurred to the same subject

— persuaded him that my
— by very slow degrees and with
— frequent relapses that alarmed &
— grieved my friend I recovered. I remember
— that the first time I was capable of
— observing outward objects with any kind
— of pleasure, I perceived that the
— fallen leaves had disappeared and that
— young buds were shooting forth from
— the trees. It was a divine spring & the
— season no doubt contributed greatly
— to my convalescence. I felt also senti
— ments of joy and affection revive
— in my bosom, my gloom disappeared and
— in a short time I became as cheerful
— as before I was attacked by the fatal
— passion .
— “Dearest Clerval,” said I “How kind,
— “how very good you are to me. This
— “whole winter instead of spending it
— “ in study as you promised yourself,
— “has been consumed in my sick room:
— “how shall I ever repay you? I feel
— “the greatest remorse for the disap
— “pointment I have been the occa
— “sion of– But you will forgive me.”
— “You will repay me,” replied Henry,
— “if you do not discompose yourself;
— disorder owed
— its origin to
— some uncommon
— & terrible
— event .

— “but get well as fast as you can . And
— “since you appear in such good
— “spirits I may speak to you on
— “one subject; may I not?”
— I trembled; one subject! What
— could it be? Could he allude to an object
— I dared not even think. Do not fright
— “en yourself;” said Clerval, who observed
— my change of colour;” I will not mention
— “it if it agitates you. But your father
— “and cousin would be so happy if they
— “ received a letter from you in
— “your own hand – They hardly know how
— “ill you have been, and are uneasy
— “at your long silence.”
— Is that all? “I said smiling
— “My dear Henry how could you suppose
— “that my first thoughts would not
— “fly towards those dear, dear friends
— “whom I love and who are so deserving
- “of my love.”
— “If this is your present temper”
— said Henry “you will be glad perhaps
— “to see a letter that has been
— “ lying here some days it is from your
— “cousin I believe.”
- Ch V– 113
— He then put the following letter
- into my hands.
— “To V. Frankenstien
— Geneva March 18th 17—
— “My dear Cousin
— “I cannot describe to you the uneasi-
- on whom

ness we have all felt concerning your
health. We cannot help imagining that
your friend Clerval conceals the ex-
tent of your disorder, for it is now
several months since we have seen
your handwriting and all this time
you have been obliged to dictate to
Henry – Surely Victor you must have
been very ill and this makes us very wretched as much so . My father was almost
persuaded that you were indeed dangerously ill, and could hardly
be re- st rained from undertaking a journey to Ingolstadt.

Clerval always wr- i tes that you
were getting better I eagerly hope you
will confirm this intelligence soon in your own
handwriting for indeed, indeed Victor
we are all very miserable on this account . Relieve
us from this fear and we shall
be the happiest creatures in the
world.– My uncles health is
now vigorous that he appears
ten years younger since last
winter. Ernest also is so much im-
proved, that you would hardly
know him; he is now nearly sixteen
you know and has lost that
nearly as
after the death
of your dear
mother

— sickly appearance that he had —
— some years ago – he is quite well & hearty —
— if I may use that term for it is —
— very expressive. —
— “My uncle and I conversed —
— last night a long time about what —
— Ernest should follow . His constant —
— ill health when young has deprived —
— of the habit of application and now —
— that he enjoys good health he —
— is continually in the open air —
— climbing the hills or rowing on the —
— lake. I, therefore, proposed that —
— he should be a farmer which you —
— know cousin is a favourite scheme —
— of mine –A farmer’s is a very healthy —
— happy life; and the least hurtful —
— or rather the most beneficial —
— profession. of any. My uncle had an —
— idea of his being educated as an advocate, that through —
— his interest he might become a judge. But besides that —
— he is not at all fit for such an —
— occupation, it is certainly more creditable to —
— cultivate the earth for the suste —
— nance of man than to be the —
— confidant & sometimes the accomplice of —
— his vices; which is the employment —
— of a Lawyer. —
— I said that the occupation of a prosperous farmer —
— if it were not a more honourable —
— profession —
— him —
— & —

— it was at least a happier employ —
— ment than that of a judge, whose —
— misfortune it was always to meddle —
— with the dark side of human nature —
— My uncle smiled and said that I —
— ought to be an advocate myself; —
— which put an end to the conversation —
— on that subject —
— And now I must tell you a little —
— story that will please you. Do you —
— not remember Justine ? —
— Perhaps you do not I will therefore —
— tell you her story in a few words. Mad. —
— Martin her Mother was a widow with —
— four children of whom Justine —
— was the third. This girl had always been —
— the favourite of her father —
— thro an odd perversity her Mother —
— could not endure her and after the —
— death of M. Moritz treated her very ill. —
— My aunt observed this, and when Justine —
— was twelve years old too prevailed —
— on her mother to allow her to live —
— at our house. —

— I dare say that you now —
— remember all about it, for Justine —
— was a great favourite of yours, & I —
— recollect you once said, that —
— Moritz? —
— but —
— The republican —
— institutions of our —
— country, have —
— produced simpler —
— & happier manners —
— than those which —
— prevail in the —
— great monarchies —
— that surround it. —

— Hence there —
— is less dis- —

— if you were in an ill humour
— one glance from Justine, could dissi-
— pate it for the same reason
— that Ariosto gave concerning the
— beauty of Angelica:— she looked so
— frank hearted and happy. My Aunt
— concieved an attachment for her, by which she was induced
— to give her an education
— superior to that which she had at
— first intended. This benefit was fully
— repaid; Justine was the most
— grateful little creature in the
— world. I do not mean that she
— made any professions—I never
— heard one pass her lips but
— you could see by her eye that
— she almost adored her protectress.
— Although very gay, and in many respects
— inconsiderate, yet she paid the greatest
— attention to every gesture of my Aunt—
— she thought her the model of all
— excellence, and endeavoured to imi-
— tate her words and even her man-
— ners, so that even now she often
— reminds me of her.
.
.
.
— When my dearest Aunt died every
— one was too much occupied in their
— distinction between
— the classes into
— which human
— beings have
— been divided,
— & the lower
— orders being
— neither so poor
— nor so despised
— are more
— refined & moral.
— A servant at
— Geneva does
— not mean the
— same thing as
— a servant in
— France or England
— —Justine
— thus recieved into
— our family to
— learn the duties
— of a servant, which
— in our fortunate
— country does not
— include a sacri-
— fize of the digni-
— ty of a human
— being.
.
— reminds

— own grief to notice poor Justine
— who had attended her during her
— illness with the greatest affection.
— Poor Justine was very ill but other
— tryals were reserved for her.
— One by one her brothers & sister
— had died and her mother was now
— with the exception of her neglected
— daugher left childless. The
— conscience of the woman was troubled
— and she began to think that the
— deaths of her favourites was a judgement
— sent from heaven to chastise her partialli-ty
— she was a roman Catholic and I believe
— her confessor encouraged the idea which she had concieved. . Accor-
— dingly, a few Months after your depar-
— ture for Ingolstadt, Justine was called
— home by her repentant Mother. Poor
— girl she wept when she quitted our house
— she was much altered since the death
— of my aunt: grief had given softness
— and a winning mildness to her manners
— which had before been remarkable
— for vivacity. Nor was her residence
— at her Mothers house of a nature to
— restore her gaiety. The poor woman
— was very vacillating in her
— repentance. She sometimes begged
— Justine to forgive her unkindness

— but much oftenor accused her
— as having caused the deaths of her
— brothers & sister. Perpetual fretting
— at last threw Mad. Martin into
— a decline, which at first encreased
— her irritability, but she is now at
— rest for ever; she died
— on the first approach of cold at
— the beginning of this last winter
— . Justine has
— returned to us and I assure you
— I love her tenderly. She is very clever
— and extremely mild & pretty and as
— I mentioned before her mein and
— expressions continually remind me
— of my dear Aunt.
— I must say a few words to
— you also, My dear Victor, of little darling
— William. I wish you could see him. He
— is very tall of his age with sweet laughing
— blue eyes dark eyelashes and curling
— hair When he smiles two little dimples
— appear on his cheeks which are rosy
— with health — his chin comes down in
— a beautiful oval After this descrip-
— tion I can only say what our visitors
— say a thousand times a day—'He is too
— pretty for a boy'.
— Now, dear Victor I dare
— her
— He has already
— had one or two
— little wives
— but Louisa
— Biron
— is his favourite—
— a pretty little
— girl of five years old

— say you wish to be indulged in a little
— gossip about your acquaintance. The
— pretty Miss Mansfeld has already received
— the congratulatory visits on her
— approaching marriage with a young
— Englishman, John Mel-
— bourne Esq. Her ugly sister Manon
— married M. Hofland the rich banker last
— autumn. Your favourite schoolfellow
— Louis Manoir has suffered several
— misfortunes since the departure
— of Clerval from Geneva But he
— has already recovered his spirits
— and he reported to be on the point
— of marrying a very lively pretty french
— woman— Mad. Tavernier –She is a widow
— and much older than Manoir but
— she is much admired and a
— favourite with every body.
— I have written myself into good spi-
— rits, dear Cousin yet I can not conclude
— without again anxiously enquiring
— concerning your health— Dear Victor, if
— you are not very ill write yourself
— and make your father and all
— of us happy or— I cannot bear to
— Your very affectionate Cousin
— – dearest Victor Elizabeth Lavenza
— write—
— think on the
— other side
— of the question
— my tears al-
— ready flow

— “Dear, dear Elizabeth” I exclaimed
— when I had read her letter”—I will write
— instantly and relieve them from the
— great pain they must feel.”
— I wrote, and this exertion greatly
— fatigued me; but my convalescence
— commenced and proceeded regularly—in
— another fortnight I was able to
— leave my chamber.
— had

Chap. 8th
one of my first duties on my recovery was
to introduce Clerval to the several professors of
the university. And in doing this I under
went a kind of rough usage
ill befitting the wounds that
my mind had sustained. Ever since the
fatal night – the end of my labours &
the beginning of my misfortunes I had
conceived a violent antipathy even to
the name of Natural Philosophy . When I was other
wise quite restored to health the sight of a
Chemical instrument
renewed all the agony of my my nervous symptoms.
Henry saw this and had removed
all my apparatus from my view he had also
changed my apartment, for he perceived that
I had acquired dislike to the room which had
previously been my workshop. But these
cares of Clerval were made of no avail when
I visited the professors. even my excellent
M. Waldman inflicted torture when
he praised with kindness and warmth,
the astonishing progress that I had made
in the sciences. He soon perceived
disliked the subject, but not guessing
the real cause he attributed
to modesty
that I
my feelings

— changed the subject from —
— my improvement, to the science itself, —
— with a desire as I evidently saw —
— of drawing me out. —
.
— What could I do? —
— He meant to please & he —
— me I felt as if he —
— carefully one by one in my —
— view those instruments which were —
— afterwards used in putting me to a —
— slow and cruel death. I writhed —
— under his words, yet dared not shew —
— the pain I felt. Clerval, whose —
— eyes and feelings were always quick —
— in discerning the sensations of others —
— declined the subject alledging his —
— ignorance & the conversation took —
— a more general turn. I thanked him —
— from my heart, but I did not speak. —
— I plainly saw that he was surprised, —
— but he never attempted to draw —
— my secret from me, and although —
— I loved him with a mixture of —
— and reverence that knew no —
— bounds, yet I could never persuade —
— myself to confide to him that event —
— which was so often present to my —
— thoughts, but which I feared the detail —
— to another would only impress more deeply. —
.
— and —
— tormented —
— placed —
— to be —
— affection —

— Mr. Krempe was not equally docile & —
— his harsh —
— blunt econiums gave me even more —
— pain than the benevolent —
— approbation of M. Waldman —”Dam n —
— “the fellow,” cried he “Why Mr. Clerval —
— “I tell you he has outstript —
— “us all– ay stare if you please but —
— “it is nevertheless true – A youngster —
— “who but three years ago believed —
— “Cornelius Agrippa as firmly as the gospel has —
— “now set himself at the head of —
— “the university & if he is not soon —
— “pulled down we shall all be out —
— “of countenance.—Aye, Aye, continued —
— “he observing my face ex —
— “pressive of suffering “Mr. Franken- —
— “stein is modest an excellent quality in —
— “a young man; Young men should be —
— “diffident of themselves you know Mr —
— “Clerval; I was myself when young but —
— “one soon grows out of that.” —
— Mr Krempe had now commenced —
— an eulogy on himself and that —
— happily turned the conversation —
— from the subject that was so agonizing —
— to me. —
— Clerval was no natural philosopher. —
— His imagination was too vivid for —
— in my then —
— condition of —
— almost in- —
— -supportable —
— sensitiveness —

— the minutiae of science. — Lan
— guages were his — principal study for he
— wished to open a field for — self-instruc
— tion on his return — Persian
— Arabic & Hebrew gained his atten
— tion — he had become perfect
— ly master of the Greek & Latin langua
— ges. For my own part idleness had
— ever been irksome to me and
— now that I wished to fly from reflec
— tion and hated my former studies
— I found great relief in being the
— fellow pupil — with my — friend and
— found — not only instruc
— tion but consolation in the works of
— the orientalists.
— Their melancholy is soothing and their
— joy elevating to a degree I never before
— experienced in — studying — the authors of any other — country.
— When you read — their — writings life
— appears to consist in a warm sun
— and gardens of roses — in the smiles &
— of a fair enemy and the fire
— that consumes your own heart
— How different from the man I y &
— poet — ry of Greece & Rome.
— Summer passed away in these
— & my return to Geneva was
— fixed for the latter end of Autum — n but
— so soon as
— frowns
— heroical
— occupations

— being delayed by several accidents winter —
— & snow arrived, — the roads were —
— deemed impassable and my — journey —
— untill the ensuing spring. I felt this —
— delay very bitterly for I longed to see my —
— native — t own and my beloved friends —
— my return had only been delayed —
— so long from an unwillingness to leave —
— Clerval in a strange town before he —
— had become acquainted with its in —
— habitants. The winter however was — spent —
— cheerfully — and although the —
— spring was uncommonly late when —
— it came its beauty compensated —
— its dilatoriness. — The month —
— of May was already — com-
— pleated, and I expected daily the —
— letter that was to fix the date of —
— my — departure, When Henry proposed —
— a pedestrian tour in environs of —
— Ingolstadt that I might bid farewell —
— to the country I had so long in —
— habited.— I acceded with pleasure to —
— this propos — ition — I was fond of Exercise —
— and Clerval had always been my —
— favourite companion in — the rambles —
— of this nature that I had taken —
— among the scenes of my native coun —
— was —
— retarted —

— try. We passed a fortnight in these —
— perambulations. My health and spirits had long —
— been restored and they gained additional vigour —
— from the salubrious air I breathed, and the —
— conversation of my friend. Study had before —
— rendered me unsocial, —I had shunned the —
— company of my fellow beings But Clerval —
— called forth the better feelings of my heart. —
— he again taught me to love the aspect —
— of nature and the cheerful faces of chil- —
— dren. Excellent Friend! How sincerely did you —
— love me and endeavour to elevate my —
— mind untill it was on a level with —
— your own. A selfish pursuit had cramped —
— and narrowed me untill your gentle —
— ness & affection warmed & opened my senses . —
— I became the same happy creature —
— who a few years ago, loving & beloved by —
— all, had no sorrow or care — when —
- happy —
- inanimate nature —
— A serene sky and verdant fields —
— filled me with extasy.— The present season was indeed —
— divine — the flowers of spring bloomed in the —
— hedges while those of summer were al- —
— ready in bud— I was not disturbed by —
— thoughts that during the preceeding —
— year pressed upon me not withstand- —
— ing my endeavours to throw them off with an invincible burthen. —
— Henry rejoiced in my gaiety and —
— sincerely sympathized in my feelings — he exerted —
- the natural —
- incidents of —
- our progress —
- had the —
- power of bes- —
- towing on —
- me the most —
- delightful —
- sensations —

— ted himself to amuse me, while he expressed —
— the feelings that filled his soul . The —
— resources of his mind on this occasion —
— were truly astonishing. —
- . —

— his conversation was full of imagination —
— and very often, in imitation of the persi- —
— an & Arabic writers, he invented tales —
— of wonderful fancy and interest. At other —
— times he repeated my favourite poems —
— or drew me out into arguments which —
— he supported with great ingenuity. —
— We returned to our college on a Sunday — the peas- —
— ants were dancing and every one we —
— met appeared joyful and happy — my —
— own spirits were high and I bounded —
— along with feelings of —
— joy and hilarity. —
- unbridled -

- Chap. 9th
— On my return I found the following letter
- from my father.
- To V.–Frankenstein
— Geneva – June 2nd– 17—
- My dear Victor
— You have probably waited impati-
— ently for a letter to fix
— your return and I was at first tempted
— to write a few lines merely mentioning the day
— – but that would be a cruel kindness
— and I dare not do it. What would be your
— surprise, my son, when your ex-
— pected a happy and gay welcome to
— beheld on the contrary tears and wretched
— ness. And how, Victor, can I relate our
— misfortune? absence cannot have rendered
— you callous to our joys and griefs and how
— can I inflict pain on an absent child?
— I wish to prepare you for the woeful
— news but I know it is impossible; even
— now your eye skims over the page to
— seek the words which are to convey to
— you the horrible tidings.
— William is dead! That sweet child
— whose smiles delighted & warmed me
— who was so gentle yet so gay, Victor, he
- is Murdered!
— I will not attempt to console you
— but will simply relate the circumstances
— of the transaction.
- the date of
- on which
- I should
- expect you

— Last thursday (May 28th) I;
— my niece and your two brothers went to
— walk in Plainpalais. The evening was
— warm and serene, and we prolonged our
— walk farther than usual. It was
— already dusk before we thought of
— returning and then we discovered that Ernest
— and William who had gone on before,
— were not to be found. We accordingly
— rested on a seat untill they should
— return. Presently Ernest came &
— enquired for his brother he said that
— he had been playing with him
— and that William had run away to
— hide himself and that he had vainly
— sought for him & afterwards wai-
— ted a long time but that he did
— not return.
— This rather alarmed us and we
— continued to search for him untill night fell;
— Elizabeth conjectured that he might have
— returned to the house: he was
— not there – We returned again with torches
— for I could not rest when I thought my
— sweet child had lost himself, and
— was exposed to all the damps & dews
— of night; Elizabeth also suffered extreme
— anguish. About
— in the morning I discovered my lovely
— boy whom the night before I had seen
— when
— seven

— blooming & active in health stretch —
— ed on the grass livid and motionless—
— the print of the murderers finger was —
- on his neck.
— He was conveyed home and the —
— anguish that was —
— visible in my countenance revealed —
— the secret to Elizabeth. She was —
— earnest to see the corpse. ^ —
— attempted to prevent her but she persisted,
— and entering the room where it lay —
— hastily examined the neck of —
— the victim and clasping her —
— hands exclaimed— Oh God! I have —
— murdered my darling —
- infant.
— She fainted and was retored with —
— extreme difficulty; when she again —
— lived it was only to weep and sigh—
— She told me that that same evening —
— William had teased her to let him —
— wear a very valuable miniature —
— she possessed of your Mother. This —
— picture is gone and was doubtless —
— the temptation which urged the mur —
— derer to the deed. We have no trace —
- at —
— present of him, altho our exertions to discover him —
— are unremitted; but they will not restore —
— my beloved William. —
— Come, dearest Victor, you alone can —
- very —
- At first I

console Elizabeth, She weeps continually & accuses herself —
— unjustly yet her words —
— as the cause of his death—
— pierce my heart. We are all unhappy —
— but will not that be an additio —
— nal motive for you, my son, to return —
— and be our comforter. Your dear Mother! —
— Alas, Victor! I now say Thank God she did —
— not live to witness t he cruel —
— miserable death of her youngest darling. —
— Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts —
— of vengeance against the assassin but —
— with feelings of peace and gentleness —
— that will heal instead of festering the —
— wound of our minds. Enter —
— the house of mourning, my son & friend —
— but with kindness and affection —
— for those who love you & not with —
— hat red for your enemies. —
— Your affectionate & afflicted father —
— Alphonse Frankenstein —
- .

— Clerval who had watched my countenance —
— as I read this letter was surprised in observ- —
— ing the despair that succeeded to the joy —
— I expressed on receiving news from my friends. —
— I threw the letter on the table and covered —
— my face with my hands. —
— “My dear Frankenstien,” exclaimed —
— Henry when he saw me weep with —

— bitterness “are you always to be unhappy?
— “my dear friend, what has happened?”
— I motioned to him to take up the letter
— while I walked up & down the room
— in the most extreme agitation.
- — tears also
— gushed also from the eyes –”I can offer you
— “no consolation, my friend,” said he
— “your disaster is irreperable. What
— “do you intend to do”?
— “To go instantly to Geneva come
— with me, Clerval, to order the horses”
— During our walk Henry endeav-
— oured to raise my spirits– He did not
— do this by the common topics of
— consolation but by shew ing the truest
— sympathy. “Poor William” said “that dear
— “child he now sleeps with his angel
— “mother. His friends mourn and weep but
— “he is at rest he does not now feel the
— “murderers grasp – a sod covers his
— “gentle form and he knows no pain–He
— “can no longer be a subject for pity his
— “survivors are the greatest sufferers and
— “for them time is the only consolation.
— “Those maxims of the stoics that death
— “was no evil and that the mind of man
— “ought to be superior to despair
— “on the eternal absence of a beloved
— “object ought not to be urged – even
— “Cato wept over the dead body of his
- “brother.”
- of Clerval
- as he read the
- account of my
- misfortune

— Clerval spoke this as we hurried
— through the streets the words
— impressed themselves on my
— mind and I remembered them afterwads
— in solitude. But now, as soon
— as the horses arrived I hurried into
— a Cabriolet and bad fare
— well to my friend.
— My journey was very melancholy.
— At first I wished to hurry on for I longed
— to console & sympathize withmy loved and
— sorrowing friends but when I drew
— near my native town I sla c kened
— my progress . I could hardly sustain
— the multitude of feelings that
— crowded into my mind. I passed
— though scenes familiar to my youth
— but which I had not seen for nearly
— five years, how altered every thing might
— be since that time? one great sudden
— and desolating change had taken place
— but a thousand little circumstance
— might have by degrees
— worked other alterations which although
— it might be done more tranquilly would
— not be less de c isive. Fear overcame me
— I dared not advance dreading
— a thousand nameless evils that
— made me tremble although I was unable

— to define them.
— I remained at Lausanne for
— two days not daring to proceed. I contem
— plated the lake – the waters were
— placid – all around was calm and the
— Snowy mountains the “Palaces of Nature”
— were not changed. By degrees, this calm
— and heavenly scene restored me, and I
— journey towards Geneva. The road
— ran by the side of the lake which
— became narrower as I approached
— my native town – I discovered more
— distinctly the black sides of Jura;
— and the bright summit of Mount Blanc–
— I wept like a child– Dear mountains
— my own beautiful lake how do you
— welcome your wanderer Your sum
— mits are clear the sky and lake
— are blue is this to prognosticate peace
— or to mockat my unhappiness?
— I fear, my friend that I shall render myself
— tedious by dwelling on these preliminary
— circumstances but they were days of
— comparative happiness and I think
— of them with pleasure – My Country
— my beloved country Who but a native can tell the
— delight I took in again beholding thy
— st r eams thy mountains and more than
— all thy lovely lake
.
— continued my

— Yet as I drew nearer home grief and
— fear overcame me – night also closed
— round and when I could hardly
— see the dark mountains I felt still
— more gloomily I pictured every
— evil and persuaded myself that
— I was destined to become
— the most w retched of human beings–
— Alas! I prophesied truly and
— failed onlyin one single circumstance: that in all the misery
— I imagined and dreaded, I did not conceive
— the hundredth part of the anguish
— destined to endure.
— I was
.

- Chapter 10th
— Night had closed in when I arrived
— the gates of Geneva were already shut and
— I determined to remain that night at
— Secheron . The sky was serene and
— as I was unable to rest I resolved
— to visit the spot where m y
— poor William had been murdered;
— as I walked I perceived a storm collecting
— on the other side of the lake. I saw the
— lightnings play in the most beautiful
— figures and gained a summit
— that I might observe its progress.
— It advanced and I soon felt
— the rain coming slowly in large
— drops but its violence quickly encreased.
— I quitted my seat and walk on,
— although the darkness and storm aug
— mented every minute and the thunder
— burst with a terrific
— crash over my head —
.
— It was echoed
— from Salève the Jura and the Alps of Savoy—
— vivid flashes of lightning dazzled my
— eyes, illuminating the lake;
— then for an instant every thing
— seemed of a pitchy darkness untill
— the eye recovered itself from the preceeding flash.
— The storm as is often the case in
— a village
— half a league
— to the east
— -ward of the city

Switzerland appeared at once in various
parts of the heavens. The most violent
storm hung exactly north of the town
over that part of the lake which lies between
the promontory of Belrive and the
village of Copet

— another storm enlightened
Jura with faint flashes and another
darkened and sometimes
disclosed the Mole –
a peaked mountain to the east of
the lake.
While I watched the storm – so beauti
ful yet terrific I wandered
on with a hasty step –
th e noble war in the sky elevated
my spirits; I clasped my hands & ex
claimed aloud “William, dear angel,
this is thy funeral, this thy dirge!”–
As I said these words I perceived in the gloom
a figure which stole from
behind a clump of trees near me –
its gigantc stature & the deformity
of its aspectmore hideous tha n belongs to humanity
instantly informed me who it
was. It was the wretch, the filthy dæmon to
whom I had given life. What did he there?
Could he be (I shuddered at the conception
I stood
fixed gazing
intently, I
could not
be mista
ken a
flash of
lightning
illuminated
the object,
and discov
ered to me

— the murderer of my brother. No sooner
— did that idea cross my imagination than
— I became convinced of its truth — my teeth chattered
— and I was forced to lean against a
— tree for support — The figure quickly passed
— me and I lost it in the gloom. He
— was the murderer!
—
— — I thought of pur
— sueing the devil, but it would have been in vain for another
— flash discovered him to me
—
— hanging among the rocks of the nearly perpendicular
— ascent of the Mont-Salève; he soon reached
— the summit and dissappeared.
— I remained motionless the thunder
— ceased but the rain still continued &
— the scene was enveloped in a n impenetrable dark-
— ness. I revolved in my mind
— the events which I had,
— untill now, sought to forget. The appearance
— of the work of my own hands, alive at my bed side – & its departure.
— two years had now nearly elapsed since the
— night on which he first received
— life, and was this his first crime – Alas!
— I had turned loose in the world a depraved
— wretch whose delight was in
— murder & wretchedness; for had he
— not murdered my brother?
— No one can conceive of the anguish I
— suffereed during the remainder of the
— therefore
— Nothingin human
— shape could
— have destroyed
— that fair
— child. He
— was the
— murderer!
— I could not
— doubt it.
— The mere presence
— of the idea
— was an ir-
— -resistible
— proof of the
— fact
— I resolved in my mind
— The whole
— train of my
— progress to-
— wards my
— creation

night which I spent cold & wet in the open
air. . But I did not
feel the inconvenience of the weather. my imagination was busy in
in scenes of evil and despair
I considered the being whom I
had cast in among mankind
purposes of horror such as the deed which he had now done, nearly in the light
of my vampire; my own spirit let
loose from the grave and forced to
destroy all who were dear to me.
Day dawned and I directed my
steps towards the town – the gates were
open and I hastened to my father's
house .-My first thought was to disco-
ver what I knew of the murderer &
cause instant pursuit to
be made. But I paused when I reflect-
ed what the story was that I had
to tell. A being whom I myself
had created and endued with life, The
was utterly improbable and I knew
well that if any other had communicated such
a relation to me I should have looked
upon it as the ravings of delirium
Besides the strange nature of the
animal would
elude pursuit, even if I were so far
as to persuade my relatives to commence it –
and
endowed with
the will &
the power
to effect
had met
me at mid
night among
the
precipices of
an inaccessi-
ble mountain
tale
credited

a creature capable of scaling the
sides of Mont-Salève? These
reflections determined me, and I resolved
to remain silent.
It was about five in the morning when
I entered my father's house. I told the servants
not to disturb the family, and went into
the library to attend their usual time of
rising. Five years had elapsed—passed as
a dream but for one indelible trace, and
I stood in the same place where I had last
embraced my father before my departure
for Ingolstadt. Beloved and respectable
parent!
He still remained
to me. I gazed on a picture of my mother
which stood over the mantelpiece. It was
an historical piece painted to please my
father and represented Caroline Beaumont
in an agony of despair kneeling by the coffin
of her dead father. Her garb was rustic, & her
cheek pale but there was an air of dignity
and beauty that hardly permitted the
sentiment of pity. Below this picture was a
miniature of William, and my tears
flowed when I looked upon it—While I was
thus engaged Ernest entered—he had heard
me arrive and hastened to welcome me.
He expressed the greatest delight on seeing
me – “Welcome my dearest Victor,” said he,
ah I wish you had come three
Besides of what use
would be pursuit?
Who could
arrest
overhanging

months ago and then you would have
– But we are now
so unhappy that I am afraid
tears instead of smiles will be your welcome
our father looks so sorrowful and it seems
to have revived in his mind his sorrow
for the death of Mamma and poor Eliza
beth is quite inconsolable.” Ernest began
to weep as he said these words.
“Do not you” said I, “welcome me thus; try
to be more calm
that I may not be absolutely miserable the moment I enter
my father's house after so long an absence.
But tell me, how does my father support
his misfortunes; and how
is my poor Elizabeth?”
She indeed requires consolation,” replied
Ernest—“She accused herself of having caused
the death of my brother and that made
her very, very wretched; but since the
murderer has been discovered”——”
“The murderer discovered!” Exclaimed I—
“Good God how can that be? Who could
attempt to pursue him? It is im-
possible, one might as well try to
overtake the winds or confine a
mountain stream with a straw!
“I do not know what you mean” replied
Ernest, But we were all very unhappy
when she was discovered—No one would
believe it at first and even now
found
us all joy
ous & de-
lighted

— that she should suffer as
— guilty – She is to be tried today and I hope I
— sincerely hope that she will be acquitted
— This speech calmed me. I was firmly con
— vinced in my own mind that Justine and
— indeed every human being was guiltless of
— this murder. I had no fear therefore
— that any circumstantial evidence could
— be brought forward strong enough to
— convict her and in this assurance I calmed
— myself expecting the trial with eagerness
— but without prognosticating an evil
— result.
— I saw unhappiness deeply impressed
— on his countenance but he endea
— voured to welcome me cheerfully
— and after we had exchanged our mournful greetings would have spoken on some
— other topic than that of our disaster
— had not
— he

Chap. 11
We were soon joined by Elizabeth. Time
had made great alterations in her form since
I had last beheld her. Five years before
she was a pretty, good humoured girl
Whom every
one loved, and caressed . She was now a woman
in stature and expression of countenance
which was uncommonly lovely — An open &
capacious forehead gave indications of a good
understanding joined to great frankness. Her
eyes were hazel and
expressive of uncommon mildness now
through recent affliction allied to sadness—
Her hair was of a rich dark auburn her complexion fair and her
figure slight and graceful. She
welcomed me with the greatest
affection “Your arrival, my dearest cousin,”
said she, “fills me with hope. You
perhaps will find out some means to
justify my poor guiltless Justine. Alas
Who is safe is she were convicted of crime?
I rely on her innocence as cer
tainly as I do upon my own. OurMisfortune is
doubly hard to us. We have not only lost
that lovely darling boy but this poor girl
whom I sincerely love, is to be torn

— away by even a worse fate – Alas if she —
— is condemned I shall never know joy more —
— But she will not I am sure she will —
— not and then I shall be happy again even —
— after the sad death of my little William.” —
— “She is innocent, my Elizabeth,” said I and —
— that shall be proved – fear nothing but let —
— your spirits be cheered by the assurance —
— of her acquittal. —
— “How kind your are,” replied Elizabeth, —
— “every one else believes in her guilt, and —
— that made me wretched —
— for I knew —
— that it was impossible, and to see every one else —
— prejudiced in so deadly a manner rendered —
— me hopeless and despairing.” She wept— —
— “Sweet niece” said my father dry your —
— tears —
— . —
— if she is as you believe innocent rely —
— on the justice of our judges & the activity with —
— which I shall prevent the slightest shadow of partiality. —
— We passed a few sad hours untill eleven —
— o’clock when the trial was to commence My —
— the rest of the family being obliged —
— to attend as witnesses I accompanied them to —
— the court. During the whole of this wretched —
— mockery of justice I suffered living torture. —
— It was to be decided whether the result of —
— my curiosity and lawless devices would cause —

— the death of two of my fellow beings. One a —
— smiling babe full of innocence and joy, the —
— other far more dreadfully murdered with —
— every agravation infamy that could —
— make that murder memorable in horror. Justine —
— also was a girl of merit and possessed —
— qualities which promised to render her —
— life happy; now all was to be oblite —
— rated in an ignominious grave ; And I the —
— cause! A thousand times rather would —
— I have confessed myself guilty of the crime —
— ascribed to Justine, but I was absent when —
— it was committed and such a declaration —
— would have been considered as the ravings of —
— a madman and could not have excu —
— pated her who suffered through me. —
— The appearance of Justine was —
— calm. She was dressed in mourning and —
— her countenance, always engaging, was rendered —
— by the solemnity of her feelings exquisite —
— -ly beautiful. Yet she —
— appeared confident in innocence and —
— did not tremble although gazed at and —
— execrated by thousands. For all the kind —
— ness which her beauty might have —
— gained from others was obliterated by —
— the remembrance of the enormity she was —
— supposed to have committed. She was —
— tranquil yet her tranquillity was evident —

— constrained – and as her confusion had —
— before been adduced as a proof of her guilt —
— she worked up her mind to an appear —
— ance of courage. When she entered the court —
— she threw her eyes round it and quickly dis —
— covered where we were seated – a tear seemed —
— to dim her eye when she saw us but she —
— recovered herself and a look of sorrow —
— ful affection seemed to attest her utter —
— guiltlessness. —
— The trial began —
— and after the advocate against her —
— had stated the charge several witnesses —
— were called. Several strange facts combined —
— against her which would have staggered —
— any one who had not such prof of her —
— innocence as I had. She had been out the —
— whole of the night on which the mur —
— der had been committed and towards —
— morning had been perceived by a —
— woman not far from the spot where —
— the body of the murdered child had been —
— afterwards found. The woman —
— asked her what she did there?– but she looked —
— very strangely and only returned a —
— confused answer . She returned to —
— the house about eight o'clock and when —
— some one enquired where she had —
— passed the night she replied that she —
— had been looking for the child and demanded —
— earnestly if any thing had been heard con —
— cerning him. When the body was brought —
— market- —
— & unin- —
— telligible —

— into the house she fell into violent hys- —
— terics and kept her bed for several —
— days. The picture was then produced —
— which the servant had found in her —
— pocket and when Elizabeth in a falte —
— ring voice proved that it was the same —
— which an hour before —
— the child had been missed,she had placed round —
— his neck a murmur of indignation —
— and horror filled the court. —
— Justine was then called on for —
— her defence. —
— As the trial had —
— proceeded her countenance had altered. —
— Surprise horror and misery were strong —
— ly expressed. Sometimes she struggled —
— with her tears but when she —
— was desired to speak she collected her —
— powers and spoke in an audible although —
— variable voice. —
— “God knows,” she said, “ how entirely I —
— am inocent. but I do not pretend to be —
— acquitted on account of my protestations —
— I rest my innocence on a simple —
— explanation of the facts which have —
— been adduced against me, and I hope —
— the character I have always borne will —
— encline my judges to a favourable —
— interpretation where any circumstance appears —

doubtful or suspicious.

She then related that by the permission of Elizabeth she had passed the evening of the night on which the murder was perpetrated at the house of an aunt who resided in Chêne a village about a league from Geneva. On her return about nine o'clock she met a man who asked her if she had seen any thing of the child who was lost. She was frightened at this account, and passed several hours in looking for him when the gates of Geneva were shut and she several hours of the night in a cottage, but unable to rest or sleep, she rose early that she might again endeavour to find my brother. If she had gone near the spot where his body lay it was without her knowledge That if she had been bewildered when questioned by the market woman, was not surprising when she was so wretched for the loss of poor William. Concerning the picture she could give no account. "I know," continued at was forced to remain

the unhappy victim “how heavily and fatally this one circumstance weighs against me but I have no power of explaining it and when I have expressed my utter ignorance I am only left to conjecture concerning the probabilities by which it might have been placed in my pocket. But here also I am checked I believe that I have have no enemy on earth and none surely who could have been so wicked as to destroy me wantonly. Did the murderer place it there? I know of no opportunity afforded him for so doing or if I had why should he have stolen the jewel to part with it again so soon ? “I commit my cause to the justice of my judges yet I see no room for hope. I beg permission to have a few witnesses examined concerning my character and if the ir testimony shall not overweighmy supposed guilt I must be condemned although I would pledge my salvation on my innocence.” Several witnesses were called who had known her for many years and they spoke well of her but fear and hatred of the crime of which they supposed her guilty rendered them timorous and unwilling . Elizabeth saw even this last resource, her excellent and irreproachable dispositions & conduct, about to fail

— the accused, when although —
— she desired permission to speak. “I am” —
— said she “the cousin of the unhappy —
— child who was murdered or rather his —
— sister for I was educated by and lived —
— with his parents ever since and —
— long before his birth; it may therefore —
— be judged indecent in me to come —
— forward on this occasion but when —
— I see a fellow creature about to perish —
— through the cowardice of her pretended —
— friends I wish to be allowed to speak that —
— I may say what I know of her character. —
— I am well acquainted with it. I have —
— lived in the same house with her at —
— one time for five and afterwards for —
— nearly two years. During all that period —
— she appeared to me a most amiable —
— and benevolent creature. She nurst —
— my aunt in her last illness with the —
— greatest affection and care and after —
— terwards attended her own mother during a —
— long & tedious illness in a manner —
— that excited the admiration of all —
— who knew her. After which she again —
— lived in my uncle’s house where she —
— was beloved by all the family . —
— she was warmly attached to the child who has been murdered and acted towards —
— him —
— like a most affectionate Mother. —
— for my own part I do not hesitate to —
— ay that notwithstanding all the evidence —
— violently —
— agitated —

— against her I believe and rely o n —
— her perfect innocence. She had —
— no temptation for such an action —
— as to the bauble on which —
— the chief proof rests if she had —
— earnestly wished for it I should have —
— willingly given it her so much do —
— I esteem and value her.” —
— Excellent Elizabeth! A murmur —
— of approbation was heard, but it —
— was excited by her generous interference & not in favour —
— of poor Justine on whom the public —
— indignationwas turned with renewed —
— violence, charging herwith the blackest in- —
— gratitude. She herself wept as —
— Elizabeth spoke but she did not —
— answer. My own agitation & anguish was extreme —
— during the whole of the trial. —
— I believed in her inno- —
— cence I knew it. Could the monster —
— who had (I did not for a minute —
— doubt) murdered my brother, alo in —
— his hellish sporthave betrayed the inno- —
— cent to death and ignominy. I could —
— not sustain the horror of my situa- —
— tion and when I saw that the popu- —
— lar voice and the countenance of the —
— produced —

Judges had already condemned
I rushed out of the court in agony. The
tortures of the accused did not equal
mine she was sustained by innocence
but the fangs of remorse tore my bosom—
I passed a night of unmingled wretched
ness. In the morning I went to the
court; my lips and throat were
parched. I dared not ask the fatal
question – but I was known and the
officer guessed the cause of my visit
— the ballots had been thrown
they were all black & Justine was
condemned.

my un
happy
victim

Chapter 1 2
I cannot attempt to describe what I
then felt – I had experienced sensations of horror
before and I have endeavoured to bestow
on them adequate expressions but now
words cannot convey any idea of the
heart sickening despair that I endured .

The person to whom I had addressed myself also added that Justine had already confessed her guilt. "That evidence" he observed – "was hardly required in so glaring a case but I am glad of it; and indeed none of our judges like to condemn a criminal upon circumstantial evidence – be it ever so decisive." When I returned home Elizabeth eagerly demanded the result. "My cousin" replied I, "it is decided as you may have suspected – all Judges had rather that ten innocent should suffer than that one guilty should escape: but she has confessed."

This was a dire blow to poor Elizabeth who had relied with firmness on her innocence. “Alas!” said she “How shall I ever again believe in human benevolence – Justine, whom I loved and esteemed as my sister. How could she put on those smiles of innocence only to betray– her mild eyes seemed inca-

— pable of any severity or ill humour and —
— yet she has committed a murder.” —
— Soon after we heard that the —
— poor victim had expressed a wish to —
— see my cousin. My father wished her not —
— to go but said that he left it to her —
— own judgement and feelings to decide. —
— “Yes,” said Elizabeth “I will go although —
— she is guilty – and you Victor shall accom- —
— pany me –I cannot go alone”. The —
— idea of this visit was torture to me —
— yet I could not refuse. —
— We entered the gloomy prison cham- —
— ber and beheld Justine sitting on some —
— straw at the further end; her hands —
— were manacled and her head rested —
— on her knees,– she rose on seeing —
— us and when we were left alone —
— with her she threw herself at the —
— feet of Elizabeth weeping bitterly. —
— My cousin wept also – Oh Justine —
— said she, why did you rob me of my —
— last consolation – I relied on your —
— innocence and although I was very —
— wretched I was not so miserable —
— as I am now.” —
— “And do you also believe that I am —
— so very very wicked–?Cried Justine Do you also join —
— with my enemies to crush me? Her —
— voice was suffocated with sobs. —
— “Rise my poor girl,” said Elizabeth —
— “why do you kneel if you are innocent —

I am not one of your enemies, I believed in
your innocence notwithstanding every
evidence untill I heard that you had
yourself declared your guilt. That report
you say is false, and be assured my
dear Justine nothing can for a minute
shake my confidence in you but
your own confession–”
“I did confess” said Justine “but
I confessed a lie. I confessed that I
might obtain absolution but now
that falsehood lies heavier at my
heart than all my other sins. The God
of heaven forgive me! Ever since I
was condemned my confessor has besieged
me,– he threatened and menaced untill
I almost began to think that I was
the wicked wretch he said I was. He
threatened excommunication and Hell
fire in my last moments if I con-
tinued obdurate. Dear Lady, I had none
to support me – all looked on me
as a wretch doomed to ignominy and
perdition; what could I do? In an evil
hour I subscribed to a lie
and now only I am truly miserable.” She
paused, weeping, and then continued.
“I thought with horror, my sweet lady,
that you should believe that

— your Justine whom your blessed
— aunt had so highly honoured and
— whom you loved, was a wretch capa
— ble of a crime which none but the
— devil himself could have perpetrated . Dear
— William, dearest blessed child, I soon
— shall see you again in heaven &
— glory and that consoles me going as
— I am to suffer ignominy and de”ath.
— “Oh Justine” cried the weeping
— Elizabeth, “forgive me for having for
— one moment distrusted you –
— why didyou confess? But do not mourn
— my dear girl, I will every where
— proclaim your innocence and will
— force belief. Yet you must die –
— you my companion, my playfellow,
— my more than sister— die –I never
— never can survive so horrible
— a misfortune”.
— “Dear Sweet lady,” do not weep”–
— replied Justine”– you ought to
— raise me with thoughts of a better
— life , and elevate me from the
— petty cares of this world of injustice
— and strife –Do not you, excellent
— Elizabeth drive me to despair.”
— Elizabeth embraced the suffer
— er “I will try to comfort you,” said she,

— but this I fear is an evil too deep and poignant
— to admit of consolation for there is no hope
— Yet heaven bless thee, my dearest Justine,
— with resignation and a confidence elevated
— beyond this world. Oh how I hate all its shews
— and mockeries.– When one creature is
— murdered another is immediately
— of life in a slow torturing
— manner & then the executioners their hands yet reeking with the blood of in nocence believe that
— they have done
— great deed . They call this retribution; hate
— ful name! When that word is pronounced
— I know that greater and more horrid
— punishments are going to be inflicted
— than the gloomiest tyrant has ever in
— ventented to satiatehis utmost revenge. Yet this
— is not consolation for you, my Justine,
— unless indeed that you may glory
— in escaping so miserable a den. Alas!
— I would I were in peace with my aunt & my
— sweet William – escaped
— from light which is hateful to me and the
— visages of men which
— “ I abhor.
— Justine smiled languidly. “This, dear Lady
— said she is despair and not resignation.
— I must not learn the lesson that you
— would teach me – talk of somthing else
— of something that will
— bring joy and not encrease of misery.”
— deprive a
—

— During this conversation I had retired —
— to a corner of the prison-room where —
— I could conceal the horrid anguish —
— that possessed me— Despair! Who dared —
— talk of that? The poor victim who —
— on the morrow was to pass the —
— dreary boundary of life & death felt —
— not as I did — Such deep & bitter agony —
— I gnashed my teeth and ground them —
— together uttering a groan that came —
— from my inmost soul. Justine started —
— when she saw wh o it was —
— she approached me. “Dear Sir,” said —
— she, “you are very kind to visit me; —
— you I hope do not believe that I am —
— guilty.” —
— I could not answer – “No Justine” —
— said Elizabeth; “he is more —
— convinced of your innocence than —
— I was for even when he heard —
— that you had confessed he did not —
— it.” —
— “I truly thank him”— said Justine —
— “In these last minutes I feel the —
— sincerest gratitude for those who —
— still think of me with kindness. How —
— sweet is the affection of others to —
— such a wretch as I am – It removes —
— more than half my misfortune —
— and I feel as if I could die in —
— credit

— peace. now that my innocence is acknow —
— ledged by you, sweet lady, and your cousin.” —
— Thus the poor sufferer tried —
— to comfort others and herself. She indeed —
— gained the resignation she wished for —
— but I the true murderer felt —
— the never dying worm alive which —
— allowed no hope or consolation. Eliza —
— beth also wept and was unhappy but —
— hers also was the misery of innocence —
— like a cloud that passes over the —
— fair moon & for a while —
— des but cannot destroy its brightness —
— anguish and —
— despair had penetrated into —
— the core of my heart – I bore a hell —
— within me that nothing could extinguish. —
— We staid several hours with Justine —
— and it was with great difficulty —
— that Elizabeth tore herself away —
— “I wish” cried she that I were to die —
— with you – I cannot live in th is world —
— of misery.” Justine assumed an air —
— of Cheerfulness whi le she with diffi —
— culty repressed the bitter tears – “Farewell —
— sweet lady, dearest Elizabeth may heaven —
— in its bounty bless and preserve you —
— which —

— May this be the last misfortune that
— you will ever suffer. – live & be happy
— to make others so.
— As We returned Elizabeth said, You
— do not know, my dear Victor, how
— much I am relieved now that I trust
— in the innocence of this unfortunate
— girl. I never could again have
— known peace if I had been deceived
— in my reliance on her. For the mo-
— ment that I did believe it I felt
— anguish that I could not have
— long sustained. Now my heart is light
— ened. The innocent suffers – but she
— whom I thought amiable and good
— is not wicked and I am consoled.”
— Amiable Cousin! Such were your
— thoughts mild and gentle as your
— dear eyes and voice.
— but I.— I was a wretch &
— none ever conceived the misery
— that I then suffered.

Chap. 13th
Nothing is more painful than when the
mind has been worked up by a quick
succession of events,
follows and
deprives the soul both of hope or fear.
Justine died— She rested. & I was alive
the blood flowed freely in my veins but
a weight of despair & remorse pressed
on my heart which nothing could remove—
.
.
.
.
.
.
.
.
.
Sleep fled
from my eyes. I wandered like an
evil spirit for I had committed deeds of mischief beyond
description horrible, and more much more (I
persuaded my self) was yet in store.
Yet my heart overflowed with kind-
ness and goodness – I had begun life
with benevolent intentions and thirsted for
the moment when I could put them in practise
of inaction & certainty
the dead calmness which

— and make myself useful to my fellow
— beings. N ow all was blasted; Instead
— of seren i ty of conscience which allowed me
— to look back on my actions with self satis
— faction, and from thence to gather promise of new hopes
.
— . I was seized by
— remorse and guilt, and hurried away
— to a hell of intense tortures such as no language can
— describe.
— This state of mind preyed upon my health
— which had entirely recovered from the
— first shock it had sustained. I shunned
— the face of man; all sound of joy or
— complacency was torture to me; Solitude
— was my only consolation deep, dark,
— death-like solitude. My father observed
— with pain the alteration perceptible in my dispositions & habits,
— and endeavoured to reason
— with me on the folly of giving way to immo
— derate grief. “Do you think, Victor” said he
— “That I do not suffer also— no one could love
— a child more than I loved your brother—
— (tears came into his eyes as he
— said this) but is it not a duty
— to the survivors
— their unhappiness by an appear
— ance of immoderate grief. It is also a duty
— owed to yourself; for excessive sorrow
— prevents improvement or enjoyment, or
— even the discharge of dayly usefullness
— without which no man is fit for
— that we
— should re
— -frain from
.
— augmenting

society.”
— This advice, although good, was utterly inna-
— -plicable to my case; I should have been
— the first to hide my grief and console
— my friends if remorse had not mingled its
— bitterness with my other sensations. Now
— I could only answer my father with a
— look of despair and endeavour to
— hide myself from his view. About this
— time we retired to our house at
— Belrive. This change was very
— agreeable to me in particular. The
— shutting of the gates of the town regularly
— at ten o'clock and the impossibility of
— on the lake after that hour
— rendered our residence within the
— walls of Geneva very irksome to me.
— I was now free: often, after the rest of
— the family had retired for the night
— I took the boat and passed the
— night upon the water: sometimes
— with my sails set I was carried by the
— wind and sometimes after rowing
— into the middle of the lake I left the
— boat to pursue its own course and
— to my own miserable reflections.
— I was often tempted when all was at peace
— around me and I the only unquiet
— thing that wandered restless in a scene
— remaining
— gave way
— .

so beautiful & heavenly; if I except
alone some bat, or the frogs, whose harsh and
interrupted croaking was
heard only when I approached the
shore; often I say, I was tempted to
plunge into the silent lake
that the waters might close over me &
my calamities for ever. But I was
restrained when I thought of the heroic
& suffering Elizabeth whom I tenderly
loved, and whose existence was bound
up in mine. And then I thought also
of my father and surviving brother;
should I not by my base desertion leave
them exposed & unprotected to the
malice of the fiend whom I had
let lose among them? At these
moments I wept bitterly and wished
that peace would revisit my mind
that I might afford them consolation
and happiness — but that could not
be: remorse extinguished every hope—
I had been the author of unalterable
evil, and I lived in daily fear

let the monster whom I had
created might perpetrate some new wickedness. –I had a n obscure feeling
that all was not over, and that
he would still commit some signal
only —

crime which by its enormity would efface the recollection of the past. My abhorrence of this fiend cannot be conceived – When I thought of him I gnashed my teeth my eyes became inflamed and I ardently wished to extinguish that life which I had so thoughtlessly bestowed. When I reflected on his crimes and malice, my hatred and revenge burst all bounds of moderation

I would have made a pilgrimage
to the highest peak of the Andes could I when there
have precipitated him to their base ; I
wished but to see him again that
I might wreak the utmost extent of
anger on his head and avenge the
deaths of William and Justine.
Our house was the house
of mourning, my father's health was deeply
shaken by the horror of the recent
events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding
she no longer took delight in her
ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed
to her sacrilege towards the dead; eter
nal woe and tears she then thought was the
just tribute she should pay to innocence
so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer
that happy creature
almost
There was
always scope
for fear so
long as any
thing that
I loved remained
alive.
nal

— wandered with —
— me on the banks of the lake —
— and talked with extacy of our future —
— prospects– She had become grave, and often —
— of the inconstancy of fortune —
— and the instability of human life— —
— “When I reflect, my dear Cousin,” she said “on —
— the miserable death of Justine Moritz, I —
— no longer see the world and its —
— works in the same light as they before —
— appeared to me. Before – I looked upon the accounts of vice —
— and injustice that I read in books or heard —
— from others as tales of ancient days or —
— imaginary evils ; but now misery has —
— come home and men appear to me as —
— monsters thirsting for each others blood. —
— Yet I am certainly unjust.–Every one —
— believed that poor girl to be guilty, and —
— if she could have committed the crime for which she suffered, assuredly she would —
— have been —
— the most depraved of human creatures. For the —
— sake of a few jewels to have murdered —
— the son of her benefactor & friend, a child —
— whom she had nursed from its birth —
— and appeared to love as if it had been —
— her own. I could not consent to the —
— death of any human being but certainly —
— I should have thought such a being —
— unfit to remain in the society of men. – Yet she was inno —
— cent–I know I feel she was innocent You —
— are of the same opinion and that —
— confirms me. Alas, Victor! when falsehood —
— who in earlier —
— youth had —
— conversed —
— At least they —
— were remote, —
— and more —
— familiar to —
— reason than —
— to imagination —

— so like the truth, who can assure them —
— selves of certain happiness? I feel as if I —
— were walking on the edge of precipiece —
— towards which thousands are crowding & —
— endeavouring to plunge me into the —
— abyss.– William & Justine were assassi —
— nated and the murderer escap es , wearing —
— human lineaments; he walks abou t —
— the world free & perhaps respected. —
— But even if I were condemmed —
— to suffer on the scaffold for the same —
— crimes I would not change places with —
— such a wretch.” —
— I listened to this discourse with the —
— extremest agony – I – not in deed —
— but in effect was the true murderer.— —
— Elizabeth read my anguish in my counte —
— nance, and kindly taking my hand —
— said–”My dearest cousin, you must —
— calm yourself; these events have affect —
— ed me G od knows how deeply! but I am —
— not so wretched as you are. There is an —
— expression of misery and sometimes of —
— revenge in your countenance that —
— makes me tremble; be calm, my —
— Victor, I w ould sacrifice my life to your —
— peace. We surely shall be happy; —
— quiet in our native country and not —
— can look —
— . —

— mingling in the world what can dis
— -turb our tranquillity?”
— She shed tears as she said this
— but at the same time smiled, that
— she might chase away the fiend that
— lurked in my heart. My father who saw
— in the unhappiness that was painted in
— my face, only an exaggeration of that
— sorrow which I might naturally
— feel thought that an amusement
— suited to my taste would be the best
— means of restoring to me my wonted
— serenity – It was fro m this cause that
— he had removed to the country &
— the same reasons he now proposed
— that we should all take a
— journey to the Valley of C h amounix. I had
— been there before but Elizabeth & Ernest
— never had, and both had often ex
— pressed a wish to see this place which
— had been described to them as so wonderful
— & sublime. Accordingly we departed from
— Geneva on this tour about the middle
— of the month of august nearly
— two months after the death of Justine.
— The weather was beautiful and if
— mine had been a sorrow to be chased
— away by any fleeting circumstance this
— voyage would certainly have had the
— effect intended by my father . As it
— distrusting the
— very solace
— which she
— gave,
— induced by

— was I was somewhat interested in the scene..it sometimes
— could not extinguish my grief. duringThe first day we travelled
— in a carriage. In the morning we
— had seen the mountains at a distance
— to which we gradually advanced.
— We perceived that the valley through
— which we wound, and which was
— formed by the Arve whose course
— we followed, closed upon us by degrees
— and when the sun had set we
— saw immense mountains & preci
— pieces overhanging us on every side
— & heard the sound of the river raging
— among rocks, and the dashing of the
— waterfalls around.
— The next day we pursued our
— journey on mules and as we ascended
— still higher; the valley assumed a
— more beautiful & verdant appear
— ance – Ruined castles ^ hanging on the precipices of piny mountains;
— the impetuous Arve, and cottages every
— here & there peeping from among the
— trees, formed a scene of singular
— beauty.. But it was augmented &
— rendered sublime by the mighty
— alps whose white & shining
— piramids & domes towered above
— all like another earth —the
— lulled, it
—

— habitations of another race of beings —
.
.
.
— We passed the bridge of —
— Pellissier, where the ravine which the —
— river forms opened before us and —
— we began to ascend the mountain —
— which over hung it-. Soon after we —
— entered the Valley of Chamounix. This —
— valley is more wonderful and sublime —
— but not so beautiful & picturesque —
— as that of Servox; through which we —
— had just passed. The high & snowy —
— mountains w ere its boundaries —
— but we saw no more ruined castles —
— or fertile fields. Immense glaciers —
— approached the road, we heard —
— the rumbling thunder of the falling —
— Avelanche and marked the smoke —
— of its passage.—Mont Blanc, the —
— supreme & magnificent Mont Blanc raised itself from —
— the surrounding aiguilles and its tremen —
— dous dome overlooked the valley. —
— During this journey I sometimes joined —
— Elizabeth and exerted myself to point —
— out to her the various beauties of the —
— scene.— And often I suffered —
— my mule to lag behind & indulged —
.

— in the misery of reflection. At other —
— times I spurred on the animal before —
— my companions that I might forget —
— them, the world, and more than —
— all myself. When at a distance I —
— alighted and threw myself on —
— the grass weighed down —
— by horror & despair. At eight in —
— the evening we arrived at Chamou —
— nix. My father & Elizabeth were very much fatigued. —
— Ernest who accompanied us was —
— delighted and in high spirits– The —
— only circumstance that detracted —
— from his pleasure was the south wind —
— and the rain that that wind seemed —
— to promise for the next day. —
— We retired early to our appartments —
— but not to sleep:– at least I did not. I —
— remained many hours at the window —
— watching the pallid lightning that played —
— above Mont Blanc – and listening —
— to the rushing of the Arve which —
— ran before my window. —

- Chap. 14
— The next day, contrary to the prognostics of our
— guides, was fine although clouded. We visited the
— source of the Aveiron and rode about the
— valley until evening . These sublime and
— magnificent scenes afforded me the greatest
— consolation that I was capable of receiving
— They elevated me from all littleness of feeling
— and although they did not remove my
— grief they subdued and tranquilized it.
— In some degree, also they diverted my mind
— from the thoughts over which it had brooded
— for the last month . I returned in the
— evening, fatigued but less unhappy and convered
— with the family with more cheerfulness than
— had been my custom for some time. My fa
— ther was pleased and Elizabeth overjoyed; “My
— dear Cousin,” said she, “You see what happiness
— you diffuse when you are happy ; do
— not relapse again!—
— The following morning the rain poured
— down in torrents and thick mists hid
— the summits of the mountains. I rose early
— but felt unusually melancholy. The rain
— depressed me , my old feelings recurred
— and I was miserable. I knew how my father
— would be dissappointed at this sudden
— change and I wished to avoid him
— untill I had recovered myself so far
— as to conceal the feelings that overpowered
— me — I knew that they would remain
— that day at the inn and as I had

— ever inured myself to rain and cold I
— resolved to go to the summit of
— Montanvert alone . I remembered
— the effect the view of the tremendous
— and ever moving glacier had
— upon my mind when I first saw it
— I t had then filled me with
— a sublime extacy that gave wings
— to the soul and allowed it to soar from
— the obscure world to light & joy. The
— sight of the awful & majestic in
— nature had indeed always the effect
— of solemnizing my mind & causing
— me to forget the passing cares
— of life. I determined to go alone
— for I was well acquainted with the
— path and the presence of another
— would destroy the
— solitary grandeur of the scene.
— The ascent is pre
— cipitous but the path is cut into continual and short
— windings which enable you
— surmount the perpedicularity of
— the mountains– It is a scene terrifical
— ly desolate. In a thousand places the
— traces of the winter avelanche may
— be perceived where trees lie broken
— and strewed on the ground; some
— entirely destroyed others bent leaning
— produced .

— upon the jutting rocks of the
— mountain, or transversely upon other trees. The
— path as you ascend higher is inters
— ected by ravines of snow, down which
— stones continually roll from above;
— one of the them is particularly dange
— rous as the slightest sound such as even
— speaking in a loud voice produces a
— concussion of air sufficient
— to draw destruction the head of the
— speaker. The pines here are not
— tall or luxuriant but they are sombre
— and add an air of severity to the scene.
— I looked on the valley beneath.; Vast mist
— were rising from the river which ran
— through it and curling in thick wreaths
— around the opposite mountains
— whose summits were hid in the
— clouds, while rain poured from the
— dark sky and added to the melancholy
— impression I received from the objects
— around me — Alas! why
— does man boast of sensibilities above
— those apparent in the brute it only
— renders them more necessary beings.
— If our impulses were
— confined to hunger thirst and desire
— we might be nearly free but now
— we are moved by every wind that
— blows & by every chance word or
— uniform

— scene that that wind may convey to
— us
— We rest, A dream has power to poison
— sleep
— We rise one wandering thought pollutes
— the day
— We feel conceive, or reason – laugh or weep
— Embrace fond woe or cast our cares
— away
— It is the same –for be it joy or sorrow
— The path of its departure still is free
— Mans yesterday may ne’er be like
— his morrow
— Nought may endure but mutability.
— It was noon when I arrived at the
— top of the ascent . For some time I
— sat upon the rock that overlooks
— the sea of ice. A mist covered both
— that and the surrounding untains
— Presently a breeze dissipated the mist
— and I descended on the glacier .
— – The surface is very uneven
— rising like the waves of a troubled sea,
— decending low, & in terspered by rifts
— that sink deep— The field of
— ice is a league, in width, but I was
— nearly two hours in crossing it – The oppo
— site mountain is a bare perpendicu
— lar rock.–From that side where I now
— stood Montanvert was exactly opposite
— at the distance of a league and above

it rose Mont Blanc in awful majesty. I re-
mained in a recess of the rock gazing on
this wonderful & stupedous scene – My heart
before which was sorrowful, now swelled with something like
joy I exclaimed – Wandering spirits,
if indeed ye wander and do not rest in
your narrow beds, allow me this faint
happiness or take me as your compa-
nion away from the joys of life.” As I
said this I suddenly beheld the
figure of a man at some distance advancing
towards me with superhuman speed—
He bounded over the crevices in the
ice among which I had walked with caution,
his stature also as he approached seem-
ed to exceed that of man –I was
troubled — a mist covered my eyes and
I felt faintness seize me. – The cold breeze
of the mountains quickly restored me.
I perceived as the shape came nearer
the sea or
rather the vast river of
ice, wound among
its dependant
mountains whose
aerial summits
hung over its
recesses. Thier
icy & glittering
peaks shone
in sunlight
over the clouds.

(sight tremendous and abhorred) that it
was the wretch whom I had created
. I
trembled with rage and horror I
resolv ed to wait his approach & then close
with him in mortal combat. He ap-
proached; I
His countenance bespoke bitter anguish
combined with d i sdain and malignancy.
But I scarcely observed this—anger and hatred
had at first deprived me of utterance
and I recovered only to overwhelm him
with words expressive of utter
detestation and contempt – “Devil”
I exclaimed – “do you dare approach me
and do not you dread the fierce vengeance
of my arm wreaked on your miserable
head – Begone vile insect or rather Stay that
I may trample you to dust and oh that
I could with the extinction of your miserable existence
restore those creatures whom you
have diabollicaly murdered”
“I expected this reception” said the dæmon
all men hate the wretched – how then
must I be hated who am miserable
beyond all living things. – Yet you
my creator hate me and spurn me

— thy creature to whom thou art —
— bound with ties only dissoluble by the —
— death of one of us. You purpose to kill —
— me. How dare you sport thus —
— with life? Do your duty towards me —
— and I will do mine towards you & —
— the rest of mankind. If you comply with my conditions –I will leave them —
— and you at peace – —
—
— but if you refuse I will glut the maw of death untill —
— it be satiated even with your —
— dearest friends.” —
— “ Abhorred monster, —
— cried I furiously, fiend that thou art —
— the tortures of Hell are too —
— wretched devil! you reproach me —
— with your creation; come, that I may —
— extinguish the spark that I so negli —
— gently bestowed.” My rage was without —
— bounds I sprung on him —
— impelled by all the feelings which can arm one —
— He eluded me easily, and said – Be calm! I entreat —
— you to hear me, before you give vent —
— to your hatred upon my devoted head–. Have —
— I not suffered enough that you —
— wish to encrease my misery–Life —
— although it be only an accumulation —
— of anguish is dear to me and I will defend —
— it remember thou hast made me more —
— mild a —
— vengeance for —
— thy crimes. —
— being against —
— the existence —
— of another. —
—

— powe r ful than thyself my height is superior —
— to yours my joints more supple. But I —
— will not be tempted to set myself in opposition to thee, I am thy —
— creature and will be even mild and docile —
— , my natural master & king , – if thou will —
— perform thy part also, the which thou owest me duties me. Oh Fran —
— kenstein, do not be equitable to every other —
— and trample upon me alone to whom thy —
— justice & even they clemency, thy affection is most —
— due. Remember that I am —
— thy creature – I ought to be Thy Adam – but I am rather the —
— fallen angel whom thou driven from joy for no misdeed; every where I see —
— bliss from which I alome am irrecoverably —
— . I was benevolent and good: —
— misery made me a fiend. Make me —
— happy and I shall again be virtuous —
— Begone replied I – I —
— will not hear you. there can be no —
— community between you and I– We are —
— enemies — Begone or let us try —
— our strength in a fight in which —
— one must fall.” —
— > How can I move you? said the —
— fiend— Will no entreaties cause you —
— to turn a favourable eye upon thy —
— creature who implores thy goodness and —
— compassion – Believe me, Frankenstein —
— I was benevolent —my soul glowed with —
— to thee —
— excluded —
—
—

— love and humanity but am I not alone —
— miserably alone – —
— You, my creator abhor me —
— What hope can I gather from your —
— fellow creatures who owe me nothing. —They spurn and hate —
— me. The desert mountains and mournful —
— glaciers are my refuge—I have wandered —
— here many days– The caves of ice which —
— I only do not fear are a dwelling to me and —
— the only one which man does not grudge —
— — — These bleak skies I —
— hail for they are kinder to me than your fellow beings —
—
— knew of my existence they would as you do —
— arm themselves for my destruction – —
— Shall I not then hate them who abhor me —
— I will keep no terms with my enemies —
— I am miserable & they shall share my —
— wretchedness– Yet it is in your power —
— to recompense me and deliver them from —
— an evil which it . —
— Let your compassion and justice be —
— moved and do not disdain me. Listen —
— to my tale ! when you have heard that —
— deny or comiserate me as you shall —
— judge that I deserve–. But hear me –The —
— guilty are allowed by human laws, —
— bloody as they may be , to speak in their own defence —
— before they are condemned Listen to me Frankenstein —
—
— If the —
— multitude —
— of mankind —
— only remains —
— for you to —
— make so —
— great, that —
— not only you —
— & your family —
— but thousands —
— of others shall —
— be swallowed —
— up in the —
— whirlwinds of —
— its rage. —

— you accuse me of muder and yet —
— you would with a satisfi ed conscience —
— destroy thine own creature –Oh praise the eter —
— nal justice of man!—Yet I ask you —
— not to spare me, listen and then, if —
— you can and if you will, destroy the work of your hands.” —
— “Why” cried I–”do you call to my —
— remembrance circumstances of which —
— I shudder to reflect that I have been the – —
— Cursed be the —
— day in which you first saw light, cursed —
— (although I curse myself) be the hands —
— that formed you!— You have made —
— me wretched beyond expression You have left me no power to consider whether I am just to you —
— or no. begone, —
— relieve me from your sight —
— Thus I relieve you, Creator —
— he replied & placed his abhorred hand before —
— my eyes – which I flung from me with violence – —
— –fro m the sight of one whom —
— you abhor.–still you can listen to me —
— and grant me your compassion –By the —
— the virtues I once possessed I demand this —
— of you – Hear my tale –It is —
— long and strange and the temperature —
— of this place is not fitting to your —
— fine sensations; come to the hut on the mountain —
— – The sun is yet high in the —
— miserable —
— origin —
— & author —

— heavens – before it descends to
— hide itself behind yon mountains and
— illuminates another world you will have
— heard my story and can decide.
— on you it rests whether I quit for ever
— the habitations of man & lead a
— harmless life or become the scourge
— of your fellow creatures, & the author of your own speedy ruin.
— As he said this he led the way
— across the ice –I followed – my heart was
— full and I did not answer him but
— I weighed the various arguments
— which he had used, & I determined at
— to listen to his tale—I was partly urged
— by curiosity, and compassion confirmed
— me.– I had hitherto suppos
— ed him to be the murderer of my brother
— and I
— For the first time also I felt
— what the duties of a creator towards his
— creature were and that I ought to
— render him happy before I complained
— of his wickedness. these motives urged me
— to comply with his demand – We crossed
— the ice therefore, and ascended the
— opposite rock.– The air was cold and
— the rain began again to descend–We
— entered the hut – the fiend with an
— air of exultation I with a heavy
— as I proceeded
— least
— I eagerly sought
— a confirma
— tion or denial
— of this opinion.

heart and depressed spirits – But I consented
to listen and seating myself by the fire which he
lighted he thus began his tale.

The first nations whose names are on record are Chaldea and India. Tradition has preserved wonderful accounts of their progress in astronomical science. To them we owe the Zodiac and many observations on the motions of the heavenly bodies which argue a much more accurate knowledge of that art than any succeeding country could boast up til the time of Galileo and Newton. But their wisdom passed away from the earth leaving faint traces among the Eyprians a race of men whose minds bear a considerable affinity with those of the Chinese. Both these people arrived at a certain point in refinement and knowledge and remained fixed: Superstiti on and slavery clouded their perceptions and a hatred of innovation, the never-failing attendant on a mind which has learnt every thing from imitation and no-thing from itself, was the natural consequence of the arbitrary government they obeyed. Their history both on ac-count of its antiquity and the genius of the nation presents little more than a list of names. Pride and a love of Con-quest was the distinguishing characteristic of their kinds kings and their magnificance was displayed either by a bloody and useless warfare on the liberties of their neighbours or by the oppression and destruction of their own subjects employed in the building of those famous pyra-mids, which, being scarcely more than shapless masses of brick or stone, seem fitted to endure till the earth itself shall be no longer.

The oppression of their own sovereigns fitted the necks of the Egyptians for the yoke of a foreign prince after a few generations they were subdued and remained for ages swallowed up in the great Persian monarchy till after the death of Alexander when they again became a n independant nation till the overpowering force of the Roman Empire reduced them once more to the condition of a Province.

- i + 64 leaves